

THE INDIA PENTECOSTAL CHURCH OF GOD

Sunday Schools Association

Text Book

Class 12

2020



Published by:

**IPC SUNDAY SCHOOLS ASSOCIATION
KUMBANAD**

SUNDAY SCHOOL TEXT BOOK

Class 12

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PREFACE

Today society is blessed with the most modern innovations of technology but also burdened with curse of immorality and mental depression and no peace. Sunday schools strive to move forward in shaping up a generation that lifts up Jesus through their words and deeds as the only answer to the problems that beset us.

The truth is that the people who influenced the world with their great deeds and contributions all have come from homes that emphasized on spirituality. World-renowned evangelists, mission leaders, theologians and the like are living testimonies of those whose spiritual lives were shaped by their Sunday schools. This text book is prepared by the IPC Sunday Schools Association in its 60th year of existence keeping in mind the changes that have come about in the field of teaching. We have taken the utmost care to strictly adhere to the basic principles of the Word of God, even while bringing about changes that are reflected in the teaching style and method. This book is prepared with much prayer and detailed study of God's Word. We welcome all you fellow teachers to use this book to shape our children to be useful vessels in the Master's hands.

In the ministry of training up children, let us work together with the abundance of God's love to influence these tender minds with the Word of God so that they would be shining lights in this world that they live in.

I present this book with prayer for the glory of God so that it would be a blessing and guide to many thousands of children and families.

Your brother in Christ,

Kumbanad
04-01-2020

Bro. Kurian Joseph
Director

FOREWORD

The aim of the Sunday school is the all-round development of the spiritual, mental, and emotional faculties of our young generation. If this becomes reality, then our children who is our future will be a godly generation. Many great people who have reached the frontiers of mission have accepted Jesus into their lives in the Sunday school. Many world-renowned mission leaders, theologians, and evangelists have been part of I.P.C. because of the strong influence of the Sunday school on their lives.

There is no doubt that this textbook will increase the desire to study God's Word, help in spiritual and moral growth, and in the responsibility towards society for our young children. I request my fellow teachers to approach this textbook with prayer and meditation to prepare a generation of young people for the Lord.

We did not have a textbook that caters to nursery children in the age group of 3-5. This has become a reality. We are also very happy to announce that we are publishing textbooks with pictures and activity-based learning for the primary classes.

We express our heartfelt gratitude to everyone who has contributed immensely for this textbook that will give a bright future to our church. We hope to continue to work with you in the future.

For I.P.C. Sunday Schools Association,

Kumbanad
04-01-2020

Pastor Jose Thomas Jacob
General Secretary

INTRODUCTION

The world today is witness to revolutionary change in many spheres. Information technology has developed rapidly. But atheism, rebellion, immorality and other evils have also increased, making man's future uncertain. In this scenario, our goal is to lead our children to Christ and impart to them a spiritual vision. It was our long-standing dream to bring necessary changes in our textbooks keeping in mind the changes undergone in the field of education. We are happy that it has become a reality. Our desire is to impart the truths of the Word of God in a lucid manner to our children. We have prepared the lessons with pictures and teaching in context.

Your prayer, timely help and suggestions were useful in the past, and we hope that it will continue in the future.

We express our heartfelt gratitude and thanks to all those who helped in writing, translating, printing and publishing this book.

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LESSON 1

GENESIS

Purpose Understand the beginning of everything in the universe, its connection with human beings and to prepare the students to know and love Jesus Christ.

Memory verses: Genesis. 3: 15, & 12:3

I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your seed and her seed; he shall bruise your head, and you shall bruise his heel.

I will bless those whom bless you, and him who curses you I will curse; and by you all the families of the earth shall bless themselves.

INTRODUCTION:

Genesis is the first book in the Bible. It is known as the book of the beginning. The beginning of the universe, man, sin, the wages of sin, redemption, family, society, tribes, languages, the Hebrew people, sacrifices, and ages are recorded in this book. The first two chapters have always been a subject of debate. Despite the debating, no one has been able to give any solid evidence to reject the truth found in this part of the Word of God. The writer did not give any detailed account of creation. Instead he used these two chapters to give basic and necessary information about creation. The next thirty eight chapters record information about a chosen family. These chapters give the promise of the redeemer (Gen. 3:15-16, 12:1-3, 49:10).

In Hebrew this book is known as Bereshith. Genesis is the Greek translation of Bereshith. The meaning of these names(Bereshith and Genesis) is beginning, starting or origin.

AUTHOR

The book does not give any clear information about the writer. This book contains historical information from the beginning to till about three centuries before the birth of Moses. However the Word of God and Church history unanimously gave the authorship to Moses.

OLD TESTAMENT EVIDENCE

Exo. 17:14, Lev. 1:1-2, Num.33:2, Deu. 1:1, Jos. 1:7, 1 Kin 2:3, 2 Kin 16:6, Ezr.6:18, Neh. 13:1, Dan. 9:11-13, Mal. 4:4.

NEW TESTAMENT EVIDENCE

Mat. 8:4, Mar. 12:26, Luk.16:29, 24:27, Joh. 7:19, Act. 7:37, 38, 26:22 Rom. 10:19, 1Cor. 9:9, 2Cor. 3:15.

The first church fathers, the Jewish writer Josephus who lived in the first century and the Jewish Talmud (tradition) declare the authorship of Moses. There was no one else but Moses in those days who had all the knowledge of Egypt (Act. 7:22). Divine inspiration, available historical records (scrolls) and traditionally passed on verbal information helped Moses to write this book.

PERIOD OF WRITING

The book was written while Moses was traveling through the wilderness. (Approx. B.C. 1441-1401 / 1450 – 1410)

The Period of discussion is about 2300 years.

The creation of the universe is beyond our estimate or calculation. The creation of man described in Genesis chapter 1 is at least before B.C. 4000. We may divide the book of Genesis into three periods:

1. From the beginning of the blessed earth to Abraham. (about 200 years, Genesis chapter 1 to 11).

2. From Abraham to Israel in the land of Canaan. (100 year, Genesis 12 to 36).
3. History of the 70 people in Egypt (100 years, Genesis chapter 37 to 50).

From creation to the death of Joseph is about 2300 years.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF GENESIS

Son of the woman 2:15

Son of Shem 9:27

Son of Abraham 12:3

Son of Isaac 21:12

Son of Jacob 25:23

From the tribe of Judah 49:10

COMPARISONS

Adam, Abel, Melchizedek (Heb. 7:3, Rom.5:14), real sacrifice, King of peace and king of righteousness (Joseph).

THEME

Beginning, fall and redemption.

DIVISION OF THE BOOK

Genesis may be divided into 11 units.

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1. Introduction of beginning/creation | (1:1 to 2:3) |
| 2. Heaven and earth | (2:4 to 4:26) |
| 3. Adam | (5:1 to 6:8) |
| 4. Noah | (6:9 to 9:26) |
| 5. Sons of Noah | (10:1 to 11:9) |
| 6. Shem | (11:10 to 11:26) |
| 7. Terah and Abraham | (11:27 to 25:11) |
| 8. Ishmael | (25:12 -18) |
| 9. Isaac | (25:29 to 35:29) |

- | | |
|-----------|-----------------|
| 10. Esau | (36:1 to 37:1) |
| 11. Jacob | (37:2 to 50:26) |

Genesis is not just human history, but it the history of the redemption of man. Genesis can be considered a spiritual interpretation of history. It can be divided into four major incidents and the history of four groups or tribes of people.

I FOUR MAJOR INCIDENTS (Chapter 1 to 11)

1. Creation.

God is the creator of matter, power, space, and time. Man is the crown of creation.

2. Fall.

Creation became unholy in a short period of time. By original sin man fell away from God. With the second sin (Cain/Abel) men fell away from each other. Genesis documents not only the course of the fall but also the promise of a redeemer through the son of the woman (3:15).

3. Flood.

As people multiplied, sin also multiplied among them. God therefore decided to destroy mankind, but Noah and his family received grace from God.

4. Tribes.

Genesis reveals that man is of one origin. All are the children of Adam. God scattered them around the world because of rebellion and construction of the tower of Babel.

II FOUR TRIBE OF PEOPLE (12 to 50)

Even though god scattered the people around the world His eyes were upon them to bless mankind.

1. Abraham.

The call of Abraham is the main theme of this book. Abraham was given three major promises.

(i). Earth. (ii) Generations. (iii) Blessings.

2. Isaac.

God fulfilled His promise to Abraham as He called out Isaac.

3. Jacob.

The supplanter was transformed to a servant and the twelve tribes of Israel came through him.

4. Joseph.

Jacob's favorite son was tortured by his own brothers. He became a slave in Egypt. God however exalted him to be a ruler of Egypt. To save his family from famine Joseph brought and settled his extended family in the land of Goshen. After the death of Joseph the children of Israel (Jacob) became slaves in the land of Egypt. Their freedom from slavery is the book of Exodus.

Genesis has 50 chapters.

QUESTIONS

1. Discuss how appropriate is the name Genesis to this book.
2. What are the Hebrew and Greek name for the book of Genesis.
3. How Christ is discussed in this book?
4. Discuss the similarity between Christ and some character in this book.
5. What are the eleven important units in this book?
6. Which are four major incidents in this book?
7. Which are the four people groups in this book?
8. What is central theme or message in this book?

LESSON 2

EXODUS

Purpose To know that man needs to be delivered from the bondage of Satan/sin and worship the Creator just as Israel who was under the bondage of the Egyptians were delivered to receive the law and pattern of worship.

Memory verses:

Exodus. 6:6 & 19: 5,6

Say therefore to the people of Israel, 'I am the Lord and I will bring you out from under the burdens of Egyptians, and I will deliver you from their bondage, and I will redeem you within outstretched arm end and with great acts of judgment.

Now therefore, if you will obey my voice and keep my covenant, you shall be my own possession among all peoples; for all the earth is my own, and you shall be to me a kingdom of priests and holy nation. These are the words which you shall speak to the children of Israel.

INTRODUCTION:

This is the second book of the Bible. God used Egyptian captivity to develop the people of Israel as a tribe of special people. A family of seventy Jewish people became the people of Israel. Now the people of Israel are millions strong and they have become the focus of the world. These special people who are provided and protected by God came out of Egypt. They were given the law, priesthood, and pattern of worship. The presence of God was with them through the pillar of fire and clouds that followed

them during their journey to the land of Canaan, the Promised Land.

Between the book of Genesis and Exodus there are about three hundred years of history (from death of Joseph to the birth of Moses). In B.C. 1871 the children of Jacob migrated to the land of Goshen, in Egypt. Because of the blessing of the Lord and the fertile land the people of Israel multiplied (Gen. 47:11). They became a strong group of people in Egypt. Then a Pharaoh named Hyksos came to power. This new Pharaoh became afraid of the people of Israel. He made the people of Israel slaves and started to mistreat them.

During this period Moses was born in the tribe of Levi, the son of Amram and Jochebed. He grew up in the palace of Pharaoh for forty years. He had to run away from the palace and live in the land of Median for forty years. While he was in Median he received the call of God and became the deliverer of the people of Israel. He went back to Egypt and with the strong hand of the Lord, delivered the people from the Egyptians. When Israel started their journey out of Egypt there were 600,000 men who were 20 years and older. Including women and children there were about 3,000,000 people (70 people multiplied to 3,000,000 people).

The Hebrew name for this book is Weellesh Shemoth—the meaning of these words is “these are the names of the children of Israel who came to Egypt”. Exodus is the Greek name—the meaning of this word is starting/separation. In Latin it is known as Liber Exodus which is similar to the Greek.

AUTHOR Verbal and other information were the basis of the writing of Genesis. However the books, Exodus to Deuteronomy are based directly from Moses’ experiences. Although some question the authorship of Moses, their arguments are weak. On the basis of external and internal evidence, the authorship of Moses has been widely accepted.

EXTERNAL EVIDENCE ABOUT THE AUTHORSHIP

Prophet Malachi. 4:4,

Disciples. John. 1:45, Apostle Paul. Rom. 10:5

Jesus. Mark. 7:10, 12:26, Luke. 20:37, John. 5:46 & 47, John. 7: 19, 22, &23. The above references are from Exodus and the authorship is ascribed to Moses.

INTERNAL EVIDENCE ABOUT THE AUTHORSHIP

Deuteronomy states that Exodus chapter 15 is of Moses. Exodus: 17: 8-14, 20: 1-17, 24:: 4, 7, &12, 31:18, 34: 1 – 17

All historic events include the name of Moses. Moses is an eyewitness to that period of history including the wisdom and knowledge of Egypt those days. Traditions, climate, plants, animals, wilderness, forests, language and style of writing are of the time of Moses.

PERIOD OF WRITING

About B.C.1450 to1410 or 1441 to 1401, during the wilderness journey

PERIOD OF DISCUSSION

About 216 years.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF EXODUS

There is no clear prophesy regarding Christ/Messiah in the book of Exodus. But there are descriptions that point to Christ. The following are the seven descriptions.

1. Both Moses & Christ : (a) prophets and rulers (b) Came to save their own people (c) Lived under fear of enemies during childhood. (d) Gave up glory and riches. (e) Are deliverers. (f) Gave the law/covenant. (g) Are mediators.
2. Passover. John. 1:29, 36, 1cor. 5:7. Christ our Passover lamb.
3. Seven festivals, all of them indicate the ministry of Christ.
4. Exodus. Those who received deliverance (Salvation) start the journey. Going through the red sea is a shadow of baptism (death, burial, resurrection, and living in the newness of life (Rom.6:2, 3, 1Cor. 10:12).

5. Manna and water from the rock, bread of life and the rock that followed Israel and the rock of our salvation.
6. Tabernacle. The Tabernacle and its instruments point towards Christ (redemption and salvation). Suffering, blood, death, beauty, holiness and glory represent Christ in theology.
7. High Priest (his dress and ministry is the shadow of Christ). Our High Priest is
Jesus Christ (Hebrew. 4:14 -18, 9:11, 12, 24-28).

THEME

Redemption from slavery through the blood of the lamb and worship.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

The redemption of the people of God is the main topic of discussion in this book. The book starts in slavery and suffering but ends in deliverance and independence. From misery and crying, the book takes the people to the glorious presence of God. It is the history of 70 children of Jacob. In the midst of torture and suffering they multiplied to millions. As soon as the people of Israel returned their heart to the Lord, God heard their cry and stretched His hand to deliver them. He fulfilled the promises made to the forefathers. (Exo.6:6, Gen.15:13, 14).

EXODUS MAY BE DIVIDED INTO TWO SECTION

1. Redemption(deliverance) from Egypt (Chapter 1 – 18)
2. Revelations from God (Chapters 19 – 40)

REDEMPTION (DELIVERANCE) FROM EGYPT(1-18)

Israel prayed to the God of Abraham for their deliverance from 400 years of slavery. God prepared Moses as the deliverer. At the burning bush Moses received instruction from God and was sent to Pharaoh. The heart of Pharaoh was hardened and he said “who is this God that I should obey and free the Israelites”. (Exo. .5:2)

Through the ten plagues, each one worse than the previous one, the power of God was revealed to Pharaoh. The plagues came to an end with the killing of all the first born of the Egyptian people. The Israelites were delivered through the blood of the Passover Lamb. The remembrance of Passover became the national day of redemption for the Israelites. From Egypt the people of Israel were brought to the shore of the Red Sea. They crossed the sea by the miracle work of God. God protected them in their journey through the wilderness with the pillars of cloud and fire.

REVELATION FROM GOD (19 – 40)

God taught the people of Israel who had received His deliverance, through leadership and protection what He expects from them. They are separated to walk with God. They are redeemed for that purpose. They were given the commandments in chapter 19 through 40. At Mount Sinai Moses received the pattern for the construction of the Tabernacle and the commandments of moral, administrative and other laws. When Moses' return was delayed from Mount Sinai the people made a golden calf and an Altar for it. God punished them for idol worship. Then the Tabernacle was built according to the pattern given by God and it was consecrated to the Lord. The Tabernacle reveals the beauty of God's holiness, redemption, the glory of God and pattern of worship. This book has 40 chapters.

QUESTIONS

1. What did God reveal through the book of Exodus?
2. Why did Pharaoh become an enemy to the people of Israel who lived in Egypt?
3. Make a short list of the importance about Moses.
4. What is the supporting evidence that gives the authorship of Exodus to Moses?
5. How is Christ revealed in the book of Exodus?
6. Make a summary about the book of Exodus.

LESSON 3

LEVITICUS

PURPOSE Redeemed people of God are to lead a holy life according to the commandments of God.

**Memory verses: Leviticus. 11:44,45;
17:11; 19:2; 20:7,8.**

For I am the Lord your God; consecrate yourselves therefore, and be holy, for I am holy. You shall not defile yourselves with any swarming thing that crawls upon the earth. For I am the Lord who brought you up out of the land of Egypt, to be your God; you shall therefore be holy, for I am holy."

For the life of the flesh is in the blood; and I have given it for you upon the altar to make atonement for your souls; for it is the blood that makes atonement, by reason of the life .

"Say to all the congregation of the people of Israel, You shall be holy; for I the Lord your God am holy.

Consecrate yourselves therefore, and be holy; for I am the Lord your God. Keep my statutes, and do them; I am the Lord who sanctify you.

INTRODUCTION

This the third book in the Scripture. The content of this book include the duties, service, worship, and sanctification of the people of God. The word sanctification is repeated 87 times in this book. Sanctification/Holiness is the main commandment to the redeemed people of God. This book commands how to serve a

holy God in holiness and how to offer sacrifices. God redeemed the people of Israel to be a holy nation and priests. This book gives instructions to the people to faithfully serve the Lord.

The Hebrew name of this book is *Wayyiqua*. It means He called. The Talmud, the book of Jewish tradition, calls it "Law of Priests or Law of sacrifices." In Greek it is called *Leutikon*, which means the book about the Priests. In Latin Vulgate the name is the same as in English. This book describes and discusses issues related the the Levi Priests specifically, not the about the Levi tribe in general.

AUTHOR

Authorship of this book is given to Moses. The justifications are the same as those given to Genesis and Exodus. This is one of the five books of Moses which is considered to all be part of one unit. Other evidences about the authorship of Moses are given below.

EXTERNAL EVIDENCES ABOUT THE AUTHORSHIP

1. All ancient writers give the authorship to Moses.
2. Stone tablets dated B.C. 1400 found in northern Syria contain writing regarding sacrifices similar to the one discussed in Leviticus which existed in that area at the time.
3. Jesus Christ gave the authorship to Moses, for the first books of the Bible. (Mat. 8:2-4 (Lev. 14:1-4). Mat. 12:4 (Lev. 24:9), Luk.2:22 (Lev.12:5-8)

INTERNAL EVIDENCES ABOUT THE AUTHORSHIP

1. 56 times in the 27 chapters it says that Moses gave the commandment which God gave to Moses.(1:1, 4:1, 6:1, 24, :1)
2. Commandments in the book of Leviticus are the same as the laws present during that period in the economical, political, cultural and religious life of the people.

PERIOD OF WRITING

B.C. 1450 -1410

PERIOD UNDER DISCUSSION

One month.

In this book there is no discussion about the journey/wandering of the people of Israel. The people were at the valley of Mount Sinai. (Lev. 25:1-2, 26:46, 27:34) Their calendar begins (Exo. 12:2) in the month of Abib (Exo. 40:17). In the first month of the second year the Tabernacle was erected. It took one year to build the Tabernacle (Num. 1:1). It is stated that on the second year, second month, on the first day the Lord spoke. Therefore the period between the book of Exodus and the book of Leviticus is the period of writing—one month.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF LEVITICUS

1 Sacrifices.

There are many things that foreshadow Jesus Christ in this book—sacrifices being of the most important among them: (1) Burnt Offering 6:8-13 (2) Meat offering (3) Peace offering 3:7, 11, 38 (4) Sin offering 4:6, 5:6, 17, 24:30 (5) Trespass offering 5:6, 7:1-7. Burnt offering shows obedience. Meat offering indicates the sinless ministry of Christ. Peace offering stands for the peace that He brought through the cross. Sin offering shows that He bore our sin. Finally Trespass offering indicates how Christ paid the wages of sin.

2 High Priest.

There are differences between the first High Priest Aaron and the Eternal High Priest Jesus Christ.

7 FEASTS (Lev. Chapter 23):

1. Passover Sacrificial death of Christ. (1Cor. 5:7).
2. Unleavened bread Holy life/walk of a believer. (1Cor. 5:6 – 8)
3. First fruit Jesus Christ, the first to be raised from the dead.
4. Pentecost Arrival of Holy Spirit & formation of the Church.

5. Trumpet Declare the commandments, while it is possible.
6. Atonement Self examination
7. Tabernacle Return of Christ and the eternal Tabernacle.

MAIN TOPIC

Holiness/sanctification is mentioned 87 times in this book.

1. As the Lord is holy the people of God should also be holy (19:2, 20:7 & 8)

2. Ministry of Priests and the Law.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK OF LEVITICUS

To redeem the people of Israel it took only three days. The rest of the book of Exodus describes the history of how those people were made to become a holy nation and priests. The book of Leviticus describes how to fulfill the duty of the Priests. The history of redemption from slavery is described in Exodus. Leviticus explains how these redeemed were brought to the place of worship. Leviticus is the manual for the Levite's duties. The book describes the worship, obedience and service of the redeemed people of Israel.

DIVISION OF THE BOOK

This book may be divided into two parts.

1. Sacrifices (Ch. 1-17)
2. Holiness (Ch.18 – 27)

Sacrifices. (1 -17):

Only through sacrifice can you follow God (1-7).

Only through the Priests can you approach God (8-10).

Only those who are sanctified can approach God. (11-15)

Only sanctified people of Israel can approach God (16-17)

Sacrifices with blood remind the worshippers that a Holy God demands another life for atonement (17:11). For atonement of a

sinner, a sinless animal became a sacrifice, because there is no remission of sin without the shedding of blood.

Holiness (18-27)

God is Holy. Therefore those who worship and serve Him must be holy. Therefore worshippers must be separated from the gentiles in every way of life. The word holy is used 87 times in this book. Holiness is to be strictly followed by the people of Israel (18 – 20), the Levi Priests (21 – 22), in their worship (23 – 24), when they reach the land of Canaan (25 – 26), and when they make a covenant (27). Unless the people of God remove everything unholy among them, they cannot follow God and have fellowship with Him.

There are 27 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. What is the main message in the book of Leviticus?
2. What are the other three names mentioned for this book above and the meaning of those names?
3. Give the internal and external evidence that gives authorship of this book to Moses.
4. How long is the period of discussion in this book and give proof of that time period?
5. How do the different types of sacrifices represent Jesus Christ?
6. Feasts are a shadow of Christ. Explain?
7. How is this book divided and explain?
8. How is holiness represented in this book?

LESSON 4

NUMBERS

PURPOSE To understand that even though the people of Israel were enjoying the provision and protection of God, disobedience and unbelief prevented them from entering the promised land of Canaan.

Memory Verse : Numbers 14:22, 23 & 20:12

None of the men who have seen my glory and my signs which I wrought in Egypt and in the wilderness, and yet have put me to the proof these ten times and have not hearkened to my voice, shall see the land which I swore to give to their fathers; and none of those who despised me shall see it.

And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron, "Because you did not believe in me, to sanctify me in the eyes of the people of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land which I have given them".

INTRODUCTION

Since two censuses were taken during the course of this book, the name is very appropriate. Censuses were taken to decide the number of people who would be placed in the army. This book explains the story of the people of Israel wandering through the wilderness. In the wilderness the people of Israel received the protection and leadership of God. However due to their unbelief and disobedience a journey which could have been completed in eleven days became the wandering of forty years through the wilderness. Because of murmuring and disobedience most of the people who started from Egypt died in the wilderness. Only the new generation was permitted to enter the promised land of Canaan. Genesis gives the account of creation, Exodus explains the story of redemption and Leviticus gives the order of worship.

Numbers should have been the story the redeemed people walking with God and having fellowship with Him. But the redeemed people failed to walk with God. When a group of people fail in their walk with God He will always raise up another group to inherit the promises.

The book of Numbers is also known as “Wayye dabbe” meaning God Spoke. This name is given on the basis of Hebrew 1:1. Also it is known as “Bemidbar” meaning “in the wilderness”. In Greek the book is known as “Arithmoi” meaning numbers and in Latin it is known as “Liber Numer” meaning “the book of numbers”. Some theologians call it “the book of journey” and “the book of murmuring”.

AUTHOR Moses

The evidences that are given for the first three books are also applicable to the book of Numbers.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C. 1450 - 1410 (Period in the wilderness)

Leviticus gives the history of the people of Israel for one month. But the book of

Numbers gives the history of the people of Israel for 39 years (B.C. 1444 – 1405). After the Israelites left Egypt on the first day of the second month, they came and camped at Sinai on the 20th day. That is 20 days (Numbers 1:1). After wandering through the wilderness they arrived at Moab (22:1, 26:3, 32:13, 33:50, Deut. 1:3). In the fortieth year, on the first day of the eleventh month, Moses proclaimed to the Israelites all that the Lord commanded him concerning them. The period of recording this book is about forty years (32:33): to Mount Sinai 20 days, in the Wilderness 38 years 3 months 10 days, to Moab 5 months.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF NUMBERS

The best shadow of Christ in the book of numbers is the “bronze serpent”. (Num.21:4 – 8, John 3:14) Water from the smitten rock will quench spiritual thirst of those who are following Him. The

rock (Christ) is the one who believers will follow in their spiritual walk (1Cor. 10:4). Manna always gives satisfaction to those who eat it. Christ became the bread of life for us (Num.11:7-8, John. 6:32-33). The city of refuge (Num. Ch. 33, Hebr. 6:18) is a shadow of Christ. The Pillar of fire and clouds is shadow of Christ who leads, guides and protects His followers.

MAIN TOPIC

Disobedience and unbelief prevented the Israelites from having fellowship with God and attaining the promise.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK OF NUMBERS

The history recorded in the book of numbers begins on the 13th month after the people of Israel left Egypt. Numbers explains the punishment the Israelites received because of their careless and disobedient activities. Through 40 years of guidance and teaching after the period of bondage in Egypt they became a people ready to receive the promised land. Numbers start with an old generation (1:1 - 10:10). They are driven through hard changes. Numbers end with a new and changed generation (26:36).

OLD GENERATION

The people of Israel were delivered from Egypt through miracles. With divine protection God brought them to Sinai to receive the Law (1:1 – 10:10). The commandments of God are straightforward and in proper order. They are to be followed in all walks of life. God who is omniscient, is the designer and perfect planner. There is no place for disharmony or problems in His plan. Looking at the design of the Tabernacle and placement each Tribe's tent in the camp is an example of the order God desires. Internal and external aspects of the Tabernacle, the camp site, and how they are to begin their journey are other examples of perfect order.

SORROWFUL END OF THOSE STARTEDFROM EGYPT

Israel in their journey to the land of Canaan followed God. However God was displeased because of their murmuring. While

at Kadesh spies were to assess the land. All this displeased God and the generation that came out of Egypt was not able to possess that land. The spies took 40 days to assess the land. At the ratio of 1 day to 1 year, the people of Israel wandered for 40 years. Except Caleb and Joshua the rest of the generation died in the wilderness. There is no detailed account about these wandering years in the book.

NEW GENERATION

When the generation was prepared and ready they were brought back to the land Moab which is east of the land of promise (22:1). Before they entered the promised land of Canaan the people had to be prepared in all ways. Therefore they were given the commandments again and censuses were taken again. At that time Moses appointed Joshua as the next leader. Some of the tribes settled east of the Jordan River.

Two type of generation in censuses Num. 1 - 14 & Num. 21 – 26

Two censuses Num. 1 & Num. 26

Two journeys Num.10 – 14 & Num. 21-27

Two instructions Num. 5 – 9 & Num. 28 - 36

The mercy and righteousness of God is recorded here (Rom.11:22). The people of God have to believe and depend upon God in order to prosper in all walks of life.

There are 36 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. Why is the name Numbers appropriate for this book?
2. List different names given to this book and the meaning of those names.
3. Describe the period in which this book was written.
4. How is Christ revealed in this book?
5. How is the content of this book divided and explain.
6. There are pairs of different matters in this book. Name them.

LESSON 5

DEUTERONOMY

PURPOSE The book of Deuteronomy is a summary of instructions given to a new generation of people. They are about to enter the promised land. The new generation is instructed to become model citizens and told of the blessing they may receive if they follow the commandments. We, the new-testament Israel, are informed to pay attention to the commandments of the Lord.

Memory verses:

Deuteronomy. 10:12, 13 & 30:19, 20

“And now, Israel, what does the Lord your God require of you, but to fear the Lord your God, to walk in all his ways, to love him, to serve the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul, and to keep the commandments and statutes of the Lord , which I command you this day for your good?.....

I call heaven and earth to witness against you this day, and I have set before you life and death, blessings and curse; therefore choose life, that you and your descendants may live, loving the Lord your God, obeying his voice and cleaving to him; for that means life to you and length of days, that you may dwell in the land which the Lord swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give them.

INTRODUCTION:

The book of Deuteronomy is the last among the five books of Moses. This is a continuation of the book of Numbers. The people are in the land of Moab, east of Jericho. After giving this final

instruction and after blessing the people of Israel, Moses departs from this world. This book contains mostly instructions given by Moses at that time. All those who came out of Egypt and murmured against God perished in the wilderness. A new generation came into existence. Here they are being instructed with the commandments of God. The book starts with the history of Israel. This book is a copy of the commandments received at Sinai which are given to this new generation with new instructions. This is not a second set of commandments. This is the book Jesus Christ referred to many times while on earth. The love of God and obedience of man are important topics in this book. Moses at the age of 120, after wandering in the wilderness for about 40 years, is repeating the instructions to the people of Israel about worship, society, morality, and holiness. All these instructions are for the general public. Commandments in the book of Leviticus were for the Priests. Here Moses is warning the new generation not to repeat the disobedience of their fathers but to obey the Lord and be blessed.

In Septuagint translation the book is known as Deutronomion Touto or the second law. But this book is not a second law. It is a copy of the law received at Sinai with new instructions. In Hebrew it is known as Ellehhadde(va)rim(bha). That is based on chapter 1:1. It means “these are the words spoken”. Jewish tradition, Mishneh Toreh calls it repetition of the Law. The name Deuteronomy is derived from the Greek name Deutronomian. Some theologians named this book the “book of remembrance”.

AUTHOR MOSES

Some critics argue that Moses is not the author of this book. But these arguments are not approved in general. There are many evidences that the author is Moses.

EXTERNAL EVIDENCES

Jewish and Samaritan traditions approves that Deuteronomy is written by Moses. If anyone questions the authorship of Moses, the language and culture described in the book are not compatible with any other time period. Deuteronomy is written in the same

style as the contracts written during the period of B.C 15 & 14 century.

INTERNAL EVIDENCES

The book of Deuteronomy declares 40 times that the book is of Moses (Deu. 1: 1 – 5, 4: 4: 44 – 46, 8:1 -24, 29:1, 31: 9).

Old testament books very clearly declare that the first 5 books of the bible are written by Moses (Jos.1:7, Jud.3:4, 1 Kin.2:3, 2 Kin. 14:6, Esz. 3:2, Neh. 1:7, Psa. 103:7, Dan. 9:11, Mal. 4:4).

Historical and geographical descriptions are personal experiences of Moses and not what was heard from others.

Joshua and 1 Samuel declare that the five books were given, to the people of Israel in the promised land in its original language.

While Jesus was tempted by the devil, He used the verses from the book of Deuteronomy (Mat.4:4, 7, 10). Jesus declares it very clearly that it is Moses (Mat. 19:7, Mar. 7:10, Luk. 20:28, Jon. 5:345 – 47).

In the new testament, it is stated 80 times in 17 books that Deuteronomy is of Moses. (Act. 3:22, Rom. 10:9). Joshua wrote only about the death of Moses.

The above external and internal evidences, show us that the book of Deuteronomy is written by Moses.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C. 145- to 1410 (1407)

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD (One Month).

Historically the book of Leviticus and the book of Deuteronomy are not different. Historically during the period of Deuteronomy the people are in the land of Moab. Moab is at the bank of the river Jordan, east of Jericho (1:1, 29: 1, Jos. 1:2). The book gives the history of about one month (1:3, 34: 8, 24 – 26, Jos. 5: 6 – 12)). At the 40th year of their wandering through the wilderness the new generation reached the border of the land of Canaan. The book is written to encourage the people to believe and obey God so that they may be blessed (Deu. 1:1).

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF DEUTERONOMY

A shadow of Christ is best seen in Due. 18: 15. It is written that “The Lord your God will rise up for you a prophet like me from among your own brothers, you must listen to him” (18. 16 – 19, Act. 7: 37). There are many similarities between Moses and Jesus Christ. Prophet (34: 10 – 12). Both are Priest (Exo. 32: 31 - 35), King / ruler (33: 4, 5), intermediaries, rejected by their own people, are great leaders and received childhood death sentences from the rulers.

MAIN TOPIC

Believe and obey the Law and be blessed.

OBSERVATION ABOUT BOOK OF DEUTERONOMY

This book is a renewed, revised and expanded version of the Law received at Sinai. This is the record of three exhortations of Moses to the people. The exhortation is about the past, present and future dealings of the Lord with the people of Israel.

FIRST EXHORTATION OF MOSES (1:1 – 4: 43)

Moses is reminding the people about the two most important things God did in the past.

1. How during the period of obedience, God delivered them out of bondage.
2. It also shows how disobedience brought the judgment of God in their life. Judgment of God upon them because of their unbelief.

SECOND EXHORTATION OF MOSES (4: 44 – 26: 19).

Moses warns the people that the blessing that will receive in the land of Canaan will be according to their relationship with God. Moses is discussing three aspects of the Law.

1. **The Testimonials** (5 -11). Here Moses repeats the 10 commandments and exhorts them to not reject the grace of God and His deliverance.

2. **The Statutes (12: 1 – 16:17).** Customary responsibilities, sacrifices, tithing and feasts are in this part.
3. **The ordinance (16: 18 – 26:19).** This may be divided into civil and social laws. This includes laws regarding criminal, war, property, personal, family affairs, and social affairs.

THIRD EXHORTATION OF MOSES (27 – 34)

In these chapters Moses is predicting or writing in advance the history of what is about to happen. Here he prophesies the blessing and judgment/punishment which Israel will receive in the near future and in their future life. Then Moses appoints the one who will take his position. He then gives them his final message about his departure from this world. Completing his ministry Moses died. God buried him at an unknown place so that the people would not go back and worship at his sepulchre (34: 10 -12). The book ends with a declaration of Moses' greatness.

There are 34 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

- 1 What are the warnings the new testament sojourners get from this book?
- 2 What are different names given to this book in other basic languages of the Bible. Give the meaning of those names?
- 3 Why is the book of Deuteronomy not a second law?
- 4 How can we conclude that Jesus Christ this book?
- 5 How can we prove that Moses is the writer of Deuteronomy?
- 6 Describe the shadow of Christ in the book of Deuteronomy?
- 7 The book of Deuteronomy contains three exhortations of Moses. Give a brief description of those exhortations.

LESSON 6

JOSHUA

PURPOSE: God is faithful to fulfill His promises. He will deliver those who follow His laws. He will lead them to the promised land and reward them.

Memory verses: Joshua. 1:8 & 11:23.

This book of the law shall not depart out of your mouth, but you shall meditate on it day and night, that you may be careful to do according to all that is written in it; for then you shall make your way prosperous, and then you shall have good success.

So Joshua took the whold land, according to all that the Lord has spoken to Moses; and Joshua gave it for an inheritance to Israel according to their tribal allotments. And the land have rest from war.

INTRODUCTION:

Joshua means “Jehovah is” my salvation. Joshua was of the tribe of Ephrem. (Num. 13:3). The names Jesus and Joshua are the same. Moses is the one who changed the name Yehoshua to Joshua. Joshua, Hosea, Yehosua and Jesus are all the same name. Joshua was the leader who guided the nation of Israel to the land of Canaan. Similarly Jesus is the leader who will guide His people to Heaven. Joshua the faithful servant of Moses spent forty years with him, during the period of wandering through the wilderness. Joshua was with Moses at Sinai (Exo.24:13). In the explanation about those who went to spy the land the use of word “us” confirms his presence there. When Joshua became the leader to follow Moses he was 85 years old. During the next 6 years he conquered the land, divided it among his people and judged the people. Altogether that is 25 years. He died at the age of 110. He was buried in the land Timnat in the hill country of Ephraim. He is known as a great conqueror, mighty warrior, great commander,

one who believed God completely and one who received the grace of God through prayer.

The 12 books following the five books of Moses are historical books (Joshua to Esther). Among these twelve books, Joshua is the first historical book. This is the first book known by the main character of the book. The book explains how the presence of God led the people to the promised land. Obedience to the law of God and leadership of Joshua are the main parts of this book. The book teaches us that we have to fight against Satan and his angels. Therefore the children of God must wear the full armor of God (Eph. 1:3, 6:10-18).

The greek name of this book is Lesous Naus, which means son of Nun. In Latin it is known as Liber Jose which is book of Joshua. Even though Joshua was the leader, it was the Lord who gave victory. This book contains only a brief history of important victorious conquests. Joshua's main qualifications are obedience, faith, courage and dedication.

AUTHOR:

It is not clear who wrote this book, however it must have been written by Joshua or some one very close to Joshua. Jewish traditions (Talmud) claim that Joshua wrote this book (24:26, 18:9). Here it says Joshua wrote this book. The book is an eyewitness account. This confirms the authorship of Joshua. All the information is recorded with words like "we" or "us" which indicate that the book was written while the author was alive (6:25). Descriptions of three cities that existed during the period of Joshua reveal another piece of supporting evidence regarding the authorship of this book.

Three portions of this book are probably written after the death of Joshua.

- 1 Othniel Kirith: Capture of Kirith Sepher (15:13-19) is after the death of Joshua during the period of Judges (Jud. 1:9-11).
- 2 The Tribe of Dan did not take possession of their land during the period of Joshua. They took possession of their land during the period of Judges (Jud.18:27- 29).

- 3 Death of Joshua (24:29-33): This was written by the Priest Eleazar, or his son Phinehas during the period of Judges. Except for the above three portions, the book was written by Joshua.

PERIOD OF WRITING: B.C. 14TH century (1407).

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD:

Geographically we may divide the book of Joshua into three.

- 1 River Jordan (1-5)
- 2 Canaan (6 to 113:7).
- 3 Israel (12 Tribes) on both side (East/West) of the river Jordan (13:8 to 24:33).

A wise military strategy of “divide and rule” was used to conquer the land of Canaan. First Joshua conquered the middle portion of Canaan (6-8). So the land was divided into north and south. Next he captured the south portion (9-10) and finally he conquered the north portion (11 -12). Then the captured land of Canaan was divided and given to all the tribes (13:1-7). First two and a half tribes were given the land east of Jordan. Then the rest of the nine and half tribes were given portions on the west side of the Jordan (14:1-19:51). Six cities of refuge were then built. For the Levites, he established 48 cities among the tribes.

It is difficult to clearly know the period of this history. However the period may be divided into three.

1. Bank of River Jordan (1-5). One month B.C. 1405. (Death of Moses, Crossing of Jordan)
2. Canaan (6 to 14:7). Seven years (B.C. 1398). Caleb was 40 years old when he reached Kadesh Bernah. In Joshua 14:10, Joshua was 85 years old. That is 45 years from Kadesh Bernah ($85 - 40 = 45$). From 45 if we subtract the 38 years of wandering in the wilderness, the balance of seven years in Canaan.
3. Dividing Canaan (13:8-24:33). Eight years. Death of Joshua when he was 110 years old. (B.C. 1390).

In total it is the history of 15 years and one month.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK JOSHUA

There is no clear prophesy or statements about Christ in the book of Joshua, but we can notice the shadow of Christ in this book.

Joshua is a shadow of Christ.

Both have the same name.

Just as Joshua took the chosen people to the promised land, Jesus leads believers

into a promised land of glory (Heb. 2:10). Jesus is leading us to a victorious life (2 Cor. 2:14, Rom. 8:37).

Joshua accomplished that which Moses was unable to do. Similarly Jesus accomplished that which the Law was unable to accomplish (John. 1:17, Rom. 8:2-4, Gal. 3:23-25, Heb. 7:18-20).

Joshua was a commander of the army (5:13-15) and Christ is the commander of the army of the Lord. (Jos. 5:15, Exo. 3:2).

The scarlet cord of Rahab is a shadow of salvation through the blood of Christ.

MAIN TOPIC

Conquer. God will fulfill all His promises. Therefore follow His commandments and continue in it. (23:14).

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

Joshua starts the book where Deuteronomy finished. Through Joshua, God fulfills what He had promised centuries earlier. We may divide this book into two.

1 Capture of Canaan (7 years, 1:1 – 13:7).

2 Division of Canaan 13:8-28:33).

VICTORY IN CANAAN (1:1-13:7).

In first 5 chapters people are being encouraged spiritually, morally, physically and militarily. The Lord used Joshua to finish

the work Moses started (1:2). Two spies are sent (not because of unbelief) to make sure the victory.

The strategy to capture Jericho and Canaan were not wise according to military operations, but God used these victories to teach the people that their victory is not based on the strength or strategy of their army. At Ai they were defeated because of sin.

The covenant they made with Gibeonite is a violation to the commandments.

CAPTURING OF CANAAN AND DIVIDING THE LAND (13:8-24:33).

When Joshua became old, God told him to divide the land and give it to the people, but there was land that was yet to be captured. That responsibility was given to each tribe. Chapter 13:8 to 21:45 is the account of dividing the land. Caleb was given a special privilege (14 & 15). The Levites were also given their portion.

Chapter 22:1 to 24:33 is the call for the people to occupy the land. They are told to believe in God, His forgiveness, and to continue in sacrifice and worship. The tribes at the east built an altar and worshipped God. That became a reason for internal struggle and war. Just before he died Joshua gave the final message that only through obedience may the people be blessed. This message caused a revival and dedication among the people.

There are 24 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

- 1 List all the names which have the same meaning as Joshua?
- 2 What is the spiritual message in the book of Joshua?
- 3 Why is it reported that the whole book is not written solely by Joshua?
- 4 Discuss the period of time in which the book of Joshua was written.
- 5 How is Joshua a shadow of Jesus Christ?
- 6 Explain the content of the book.
- 7 Name the places geographically connected to the book of Joshua. Give a short historical summary of the book of Joshua.

LESSON 7

JUDGES

PURPOSE People who do not submit to the will of God will face persecution and failure. But those who repent and return will be delivered by the Lord.

Memory verses:

Jug: 2:20, 21 & 21:25.

And the men of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin; and the men of Israel drew up the battle line against them at Gibeah. The Benjaminites came out of Gibeah, and felled to the ground on that day twenty thousand men of Israelites.

In those days there was no king in Israel; every man did what was right in his own eyes.

INTRODUCTION

This book contains the history of mighty men of God who judged the people of Israel. It is the history of Israel for about 300 years, from death of Joshua to Samuel. After the death of Joshua the people of Israel did not have a strong or safe leadership. Each of the 12 tribes lived for their prosperity, but did not have a common goal. From time to time God raised-up Judges who ruled them. During this period often people rejected their God and followed the gentiles around them and went into idolatry. They quarreled with each other and came under the threat of their enemies. As a people they did not prosper. In this book we may see 13 men and 1 woman whom God raised up to rule His

people. None of them had the leadership quality of Joshua or his power. While the book Joshua is a book of victory the book of Judges is a book of failure.

God raised up Judges from different tribes at different times. None of them ruled all 12 tribes of Israel. There are times when more than one Judge ruled at the same time. (Deborah & Barak). The title Judges means those who ruled from death of Joshua to King Saul. When the people became disobedient and started idol worship God gave them up into the hands of the gentiles around them.

God raised up Judges when the following thing happened.

- 1 People rebelled against God.
- 2 God punished them by giving them up into the hands of their enemies.
- 3 In their bondage and suffering they repent and confess their sin.
- 4 To deliver the people from the hands of their enemies God raised up Judges who ruled over them. This brought peace in the midst of the people. This was an ongoing cycle for that period. This repeated 7 times. During this period in this book people lived according to their own will (17:6, 18:1, 19:1, 21:25). This period lasted about 400 years.

The name of this book in Hebrew is *Shafat*. It means Judge, execute righteousness. Judges means rulers, deliverers and saviors. They have delivered the people from those who persecute them, and execute righteousness among the people. In Greek the book is known as "Kritai" and in Latin it is known as "Liber Judicum" (Book of Judges).

AUTHOR

Many scholars and tradition books think that this book is written by either the Prophet Samuel or by one of the disciples of Samuel. According to Jewish records and the Talmud the book is written by the Prophet Samuel. The main connection between Judges and Kings is the Prophet Samuel.

It is clear from the statement in 1 Samuel 4:3-11 that there were Kings at that time. The statement that there was no King in those days means there is a King at the present. Therefore it is written at the beginning of King Saul's reign but before the kingdom was divided in two. Jebusites inhabited Jerusalem in that day, which indicates it was written before the time of King David. King David is the one who removed the Jebusites from Jerusalem. Therefore before King David, Samuel is the one who wrote this book. Most scholars believe that Samuel wrote this book. The language and style of prophesy indicates that a major portion of this book is written by one person (Jud. 18:29 – 31, 20:27). Samuel likely started to write this book before the Assyrian captivity indicated in Psl.78:61.

PERIOD OF WRITING

After the reign of King Saul started in B.C.1020 and before King David captured Jerusalem (between 1043 and 1004).

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

After the time of Joshua many gentiles persecuted Israel for period of 111years. During that period there were no Judges. Then God raised up Judges. From Othniel to Samson there were 14 Judges including one woman. Their period of rule was 299 years. Samuel ministered for 40 years. Therefore the total period of the Judges is approximately 450 years ($299+110+40=449$) (Act. 13:19-20).

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF JUDGES

All Judges are saviors, rulers, spiritual and political deliverers. All of them are shadows of Christ. Christ is the righteous King, great prophet, great high priest. Judges 6:11-16 shows Christ as a redeeming angel of the Lord.

MAIN TOPIC

God will punish those who are disobedient. Those who repent will be delivered through His hand and bring them back to the fold.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

After the death of Joshua the people of Israel fell into an age to darkness. They continued to capture land after the death of Joshua. The new generation did not know the Lord or what He had done for the people (2:7-10, 24:31). The book starts with spiritual decay of the people. Their defeat and deliverance is repeated seven times. At closing the book explains about the moral decay of Israel.

ISRAEL IN MORAL DECAY (1:1-3:4)

After Joshua, the Judges start with a strong military. However they were soon defeated and driven out by the enemies. Even though there was a lack of strong leadership, the reason for defeat was something else. They were defeated because of unbelief and disobedience (2:1-3). Friendship with gentiles was a primary cause of their defeat and problems. The cancer of immorality invaded them and became a trap for them (2:3, 2:11- 23). This is repeated in chapter 3 to 10.

Chapter 3:5 to 16:31 gives the account of Israel's 7 periods of unbelief, 7 periods of punishment and 7 occasions of deliverance. [repetition of cycles of of sin, punishment, persecution, call upon God, repentance, restoration, deliverance (salvation), rest and peace].

Judges gave leadership to the internal affairs and military activities of the tribes. The book of Judges shows the rule of 14 Judges. In the book of 1 Samuel there are 4 more Judges mentioned (They are Eli, Samuel, Joel, Abiav). In the book of Judges there are 14. They are Othniel, Ehud, Shamgar, Deborah (woman), Barak, Gideon, Abimelech, Tola, Jair, Jephthah, Ibzan, Elon, Abdon and Samson.

ISRAEL'S UNCLEANNES

- 1 Spiritual uncleanness.
- 2 Social and moral uncleanness.

These were the conditions during the rule of Judges. This was the worst condition of the people of Israel mentioned in the scriptures. The book of Judges came to an end with a statement of this condition.

There are 21 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. Israel was in an age of darkness after the death of Joshua. Explain.
 2. God raised up Judges from time to time. What was the common reason this?
 3. What are different names given to this book in basic Biblical languages.
 4. What are the evidences that Joshua is the author of this book?
 5. Discuss the writing period of this book.
 6. Analyzing this book one may divide it into three sections. Explain them.
 7. How do the final verses in this book present the rule of the Judges?
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LESSON 8

RUTH

PURPOSE: Gentiles can become part of the family of God. Boas is a shadow of Christ, the redeemer of mankind.

Memory verses: Ruth. 1:6 & 3:11

Then she started with her daughters-in-law to return from the country of Moab, for she had heard in the country of Moab that the Lord had visited his people and given them food.

And now, my daughter, do not fear, I will do for you all that you ask, for all my fellow towns men know that you are the woman of worth.

INTRODUCTION

This is a beautiful story of a young woman. After going through a hard time in her life, finally she is enjoying peace. It is the

pleasant family history during the backsliding, unruly, unholy period of Judges. Abraham was called to bring out a holy family. Ruth was called to present a redeemer to the people of Israel. Ruth, grandmother of David became the great grandmother of Jesus Christ. Starting from the book of Ruth, the old testament is centered on David. The story of this book is an example of the redemptive work of Jesus Christ.

The meaning of the name Ruth is “friend”. She was a woman from Moab. First she became wife of Mahlon. After the death of Mahlon she became the wife of Boaz. The family of Elimelech (Naomi, Mahlon and Chilion) went to Moab when there was famine in the land of Bethlehem. Mahlon married Ruth and Chilion married Orpah. All the men died at Moab. Ruth came to Bethlehem with Naomi. Approximately B.C.1100 they reached the field of Boaz their kinsman redeemer. There, Ruth became the wife of Boaz. They had a son named Obed, who is the father of Jesse, father of David. Boaz’ and Ruth’s names are in the geneology of Jesus Christ (Mat. 1:5). This is a book known by a woman’s name.

In Hebrew also this book is known as Ruth. Ruth is a modified version of the Moabite name “Reuit”. In Greek the book is known as “Routh”. In Latin also it is known as Ruth.

AUTHOR

It is not clear who wrote the book of Ruth. The Babylon Talmud gives authorship to Samuel, but there is no evidence for that in the book of Ruth or elsewhere in the scripture. When King Saul disobeyed God, Samuel anointed David as King. When Samuel died Saul was alive. Therefore it is possible that Samuel thought it best to write about the geneology and tradition of David. This story happened during the reign of Judges (1:1). There is no indication of Solomon’s history. This book may have been written before David started his reign. It is written in 1 Samuel 25:1 that Samuel died. David started his reign after that.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C.1100 (TENTH CENTURY B.C.) at the early part of David’s life, B.C. 1059.

HISTROY OF THE PERIOD (11 years and few months).

We may divide the book of Ruth into four.

1. Moab (1:1-8)
2. Barley field at Bethlehem (1:19-2:223).
3. "Floor" in Bethlehem (3:1-18).
4. Town of Bethlehem (4:1-22).

Moab is at the northeast of part of the Dead Sea. People of Moab were of the generations of Lot. They were idol worshippers. There are two records in the scripture regarding the people of Moab attacking Israel (Jud. 3:12-30, 1Samuel 14:47). The history of Ruth took place between these two attacks.

Ruth 1:1 clearly states that it happened during the reign of Judges. As stated above, the condition of the people was degenerating spiritually, morally and socially. However there was a remnant who lived in the fear and faith of God. It is difficult to date the incident. But the period may be calculated:

- 1 Ruth in Moab – 10 years (1:1-18)
- 2 Ruth in Bethlehem barley field – About three months (1:19-2:28).
- 3 Ruth in "floor" – One day (3:1-18).
- 4 Ruth in town of Bethlehem - One year (4:1-22).

Total 11 years, 3 months and 1 day.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF RUTH

Kinsman redeemer (3:9). Qualification of a Kinsman redeemer.

- 1 Must be blood related (Deu.25:5, 7-10, John. 1:14, Rom. 1:3, Phi. 2:5-8, Heb. 2:24 &15).
- 2 Rich enough to pay for the redemption (Rut.2:1, 1 Pet. 1:18-19).
- 3 Must be willing to act (Ruth. 3:12, Mat.20:28, Joh.10:15, 18, Heb. 10:7).
- 4 Ready and willing to surrender self.

Kinsman redeemer is mentioned 13 times, which is a shadow of Christ.

MAIN TOPIC

Kinsman, redeemer, the beginning of the family of the Messiah, gentiles can be a member of the family of God.

OBSERVATIONS ABOUT THE BOOK

The story happened during the period of Judges. It was written during the period of David. Beyond her imagination Ruth is blessed. When there was moral decay Ruth remained faithful, righteous and gave reverence to God (3:11). She always was polite and decent with her mother-in-law and her husband Boaz.

Her love is seen in the 1st and 2nd chapters. Reward of love is seen in the 3rd and 4th chapters.

RUTH EXPRESSED HER LOVE (1ST & 2ND CHAPTERS)

The book of Ruth starts with famine in the land. Famine is the result of disobedience and lack of devotion (Deu.28-30). Elimelech (which means God is my King) is leaving Bethlehem (house of bread) because of famine. He came to Moab and lives there. His sons Mahlon and Chilion both took wives from Moab. Naomi (sweet) is the wife of Elimelech. Her husband and both the sons died at Moab. Naomi returned to Bethlehem with Ruth. Naomi complained about her condition without realizing the provision of God. Ruth went into the field of Boaz even though the people harvesting barley harassed her. Boaz started to take care of her and love her.

RUTH RECEIVED REWARD FOR HER LOVE (3RD & 4TH CHAPTERS)

According to the traditions of those days Boaz did not initiate to marry her (3:10- 13). Because there was another kinsman who was much closer to Boaz. Boaz is 20 years older than Ruth. But god helped Ruth. Boaz became her husband. Obed, David and Jesus Christ are in her lineage.

There 4 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS:

- 1 What is the main message of the book of Ruth?
 - 2 What is the greatness received for Ruth's family?
 - 3 In which languages is this book known as Ruth and what are other names for this book?
 - 4 Who is the author of this book? Give the evidences.
 - 5 What is writing period of this book?
 - 6 How redeemer in Ruth is a shadow of Christ?
 - 7 Give a brief observation about this book.
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LESSON 9

1 SAMUEL

PURPOSE To understand the power of prayer. When one man becomes unfaithful, God will appoint another one in his place. Those who honor the authority of God will be given authority.

Memory verses:
1 Samuel. 13:14 & 15:22

But now your kingdom shall not continue; the Lord has sought out a man after his own heart; and the Lord has appointed him to be prince over his people, because you have not kept what the Lord commanded you.

And Samuel said, "Has the Lord as great the delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the Lord? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.

INTRODUCTION

The reign of the Kings is the main subject of this book. Transition is a key word in this topic. Transition of Lordship over the people to Kingship. Transition of authority to reign over the people went from the Priest Eli to Samuel, then from Samuel to Saul, and finally from Saul to David. Samuel, Saul and David are the three main characters of this book. Samuel is the main connection between the reign of the Judges to the reign of the Kings. The book of Hebrews treats first and second Samuel as one book. First Samuel begins with the story of Samuel but David is the main character of this book. It deals with the life of Samuel, Saul, and the election and anointing of David as King. Samuel who was from the tribe of Levi served as a Priest, Prophet and Judge. The name Samuel means answer of prayer. His father was Elkanah and mother was Hannah who lived at Mount Ephraim. He was born in approximately B.C.1080. Septuagint translations call the books of Samuel the first and second kingdom. The Septuagint calls the books of Kings the third and fourth Kingdom. The Latin Vulgate also accepted this division of the books. The Latin Vulgate calls this book "Libbi Regum" (books of kings). Later they also accepted the translation of Hebrew and Greek names (Liber Samuelis). David first reigned in Hebron for seven years. Later, after the death of Saul he ruled over all of Israel 33 years (total 40 years). The book is generally known as the book of Samuel.

AUTHOR

The beginning portion of First Samuel may have been written by Samuel himself. 1 Samuel 25:1 is discussed the death of Samuel, therefore the later portion clearly was not written by Samuel. It must have been written by one of the contemporary prophets of Samuel, like Gad or Nathan (1 Chr. 29:29). Second Samuel was not written by Samuel. The school of prophets probably gave the name to honor Samuel. Jewish scholars think that the author is Samuel.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C. 1100 – 1025 (10th century B.C.)

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

The first portions of the book of First Samuel are not describing death of Samuel or division of Kingdom, therefore the reign of David is the content of most parts of the discussion. The first 24 chapters may have been written by Samuel before his death. He was born in B.C. 1015. About 115 years of history, from B.C. 1105 to 1011 (ministry Eli, birth of Samuel, death of Saul) are recorded in this book.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OS SAMUEL

Samuel as a prophet, Priest and Judge (King) is a shadow of Christ. David is shadow of Christ. Both were born in Bethlehem. Both are shepherds, and King of Israel. David was anointed as king, a forerunner of Christ. David wrote Psalm 22 in his suffering which is a prophesy of the suffering Christ was to endure in the future. Both David and Christ are men after the heart of God.

MAIN TOPIC

Transition of God's reign into the reign of human kings. From Samuel to Saul to David.

OBSERVATION OF THE BOOK

Samuel Chapter 1 to 7, main character is Samuel

Samuel Chapter 8 to 15, main character is Saul.

Samuel Chapter 16 to 31 main character is David.

SAMUEL (1-7)

Story of Samuel starts when Eli was the Priest and Judge. Birth of Samuel, call from God, Samuel's obedience leading to his becoming a Prophet.

In those days, there was not much word of prophesy from God. Samuel was ministering as a prophet in Shiloh. The immoral sons of Eli were also there. Israel was defeated in battle and the

ark of God was taken by the enemies. Samuel was the Judge and the Prophet (7:3-17). There was then revival among the people. The ark of God is brought back. The sons of Eli were immoral. The people were asking Samuel for a King like the gentiles (8:5-20).

SAUL (8-15)

People were asking for the reign of man in place of the reign of God. They were looking for a King (3:5, 9:2), but their choice was wrong. At first, the reign of Saul was good but it became bad. He did not honor God or Samuel (12). He misunderstood that he is also a Priest. As noted in 2 Chro. 26:18, he offered sacrifice (13). He disobeyed commandments of God (14) did not destroy the Amalekites completely. Samuel warned Saul but Saul was disobedient and defeated in battle (15:24-31).

SAUL AND DAVID (16-31)

God rejected Saul. God chose and elected David and anointed him through Samuel. (16:14- 23:29). Goliath was killed by David (17). Jonathan became fond of David. Saul became jealous of David. Jonathan protects David from Saul. David's wife Michal also protected him. David is in the land of the Philistines (22). God gave David a way to escape from Saul two more time from the Saul (24-26). David again went to the land of Philistine. Saul goes to a woman with "familiar spirit" at Endor (28). Saul and his children are killed at mount Gilboa.

There are 31 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS:

- 1 How are the books of Samuel and Kings are divided by different scholars?
- 2 This is a book of changes. What kind of changes?
- 3 Is the book of Samuel completely written by Samuel? If not explain.
- 4 Briefly explain the history of that period.
- 5 Who are the main characters in the book of First Samuel?
- 6 How does this book show that God will replace those who are unfaithful with those who are faithful?

LESSON 10

2 SAMUEL

PURPOSE The kingdom of David is chosen by God as the beginning of the eternal kingdom of God. Disobedience of David affected the course of his entire life. Sin leads to many family problems, even murder. This story addresses the consequences of sin.

Memory verses:

2 Samuel. 7:12, 13 & 22:21

When your days are fulfilled and you lie down with your fathers, I will raise up your offspring after you, who shall come forth from your body, and I will establish his kingdom. He shall build a house for my name, and I will establish the throne of the kingdom for ever.

"The Lord rewarded me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands he recompensed me.

INTRODUCTION

Reign of David is the beginning of eternal reign of Jesus Christ. After the death of King Saul, David reigned in Judah for 7 years. He then reigned from Jerusalem for 33 years. He died at the age of 70 years. This book is the history of David. Sin will always be judged by God. God will forgive but the sinner will have to face the consequences. But obedience will lead to blessings. Reign of David is written from 1 Samuel 16:12 to 1 King 2:11. This book is about the 40 years of King David's reign (B.C. 1011 -971).

AUTHOR See author of 1st Samuel

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C. 1011 (10th century B.C.).

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD:

David became King in 1011 B.C. His 33 years of reign came to an end in 971 B.C. Most part of that period is in 2 Samuel (38 years).

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF 2 SAMUEL

David is a shadow of Christ. Both were faithful servants, who followed the will of God whole heartedly. An Ideal King is righteous, has wisdom, and grace. According to the order of Melchizedek Christ is known as the eternal king. He is the son of King David.

MAIN TOPIC: David, his enemies, military leaders and reign.

OBSERVATION OF THE BOOK

2nd Samuel starts where 1st Samuel comes to an end. David who was chosen by God starts his reign after the death of Saul. David is seen as the mid point from Abraham to Christ. David's life may be divided in to three parts.

1 Victories of David (1 – 100).

2 Sin of David (11).

3 Problems of David (12 – 24).

1 VICTORIES OF DAVID

Chapter 1-4 shows reign of David in Judah. After death of Saul his son Ishbosheth came on the throne as a puppet of Abner. David's military leader, Yoab, killed Ithbaiah. Ishbosheth was killed by his own people. Then David became King over all of Israel. David obeyed the Lord by bringing the ark of the Lord to Jerusalem (8-10). David had victory where ever he went.

2 SIN OF DAVID (CHAPTER 12)

This chapter presents David's Sin of adultery and murder (he sent Uriah to be killed in battle and took his wife). Because of this

sin he lost many blessing that he could have received. Following chapters show how the kingdom had to face many problems.

3 OPPOSITIONS AND PROBLEMS DAVID HAD TO FACE

The kingdom became disobedient. Disobedience caused to diminish glory of God among the people. God sent His prophet Nathan to David. God forgave David, but a curse was upon his family. His son Absalom killed Amnon. Absalom dethroned his father and became King. David's army fought and Absalom was killed. David was on the throne again. Again there was an opposition under the leadership of Sheba. But Yoab defeated the rebellion. Last chapters are of David's history. Every one joined David. Obedience to the Lord brought blessing and rebellion brought persecution.

There are 24 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. Give evidence about the power of Samuel's prayer.
2. Why it is stated that David is the beginning of eternal reign?
3. How many years did David reign in total? How can we divide his reign?
4. Give a brief description about the history of this period.
5. How and why does David shadow Christ?
6. Write an observation of the book of 2 Samuel

LESSON 11

1 KINGS

PURPOSE To receive the promises, one has to follow all commandments whole heartedly. More over positions or blessings received may be taken back.

Memory verses:
1 Kings. 9:5 & 11:11.

then I will establish your royal throne over Israel for ever, as I promised David your father, saying, 'There shall not fail you a man upon the throne of Israel.'

Therefore the Lord said to Solomon, "Since this has been your mind and you have not kept my covenant and my statutes which I have commanded you, I will surely tear the kingdom from you and will give it to your servant."

INTRODUCTION

Reign of King Solomon is considered as the golden age in the history of the Hebrews/Israel. Construction of the temple, law and order, and wisdom from God are the most important aspects of Solomon's reign. In the Hebrew Bible 1st and 2nd Kings is one book. The Septuagint translators divided this book into two. 1st Kings starts with the greatness of the Hebrew people. 2nd Kings ends with tragedy of the people. 1st and 2nd Kings gives history of about 400 years (1000 to 600 B.C.). It records history from the death of David to the establishment of the kingdom of Judah and Israel. The main characters of 1st Kings are Solomon, Elijah, and Ahab.

Twenty kings of Judah are the descendants of David. Nine kings of Israel are from 9 different tribes. Eight of them were either killed or committed suicide. In Judah there was revival from time to time. There was no revival in Israel. Reign of Kings of Judah was 345 years and reign of Kings of Israel was 210 years.

About half of 1st King is the history of Solomon. He deserves honor because he built the temple. However his action of marrying gentile women and making affiliations with these women's nation caused weakness in the kingdom. His gentile wives caused him to go after other gods and that was the reason for the deterioration of his kingdom. Therefore he departed from this world as a heart broken man. The kingdom was divided into two. Most of the Kings were disobedient to God, His commandments, and Prophets. This further led to the deterioration of the kingdom. Israel was known as the northern and Judah was known as the southern kingdom. After the fall of Samaria, the northern kingdom came to an end under the attack of the Assyrians and the southern kingdom came to an end by the attack Babylon (B.C. 972 to 560).

In the original manuscripts the book is known as Melechim (Kings). In Hebrew manuscripts the books of Samuel, Kings, and Deuteronomy are one book. Septuagint translators may have divided this book to make it smaller. In Latin Vulgate, it is known as Liber Regum Tertius et quartus or 1st, 2nd, 3rd and 4th Kings.

AUTHOR

Author of this book is not known. Jewish Talmud says that Prophet Jeremiah (Baba Barta) is the author of this book. Jeremiah was taken to Babylon by Nebuchadnezzar. Then Babylon was defeated by Egyptians. Jeremiah died there, when he was over 90 years of age. It is believed that the book is written by Jeremiah while he was in Babylon or before that. Some believe that the book is written by a contemporary of Jeremiah. A prophet, who saw and experienced the pain, wrote this book with the help of historical books and facts.

Some of the historical books used by the author are mentioned in this book.

1 Acts of Solomon (1Kings. 12:41).

2 Chronicles of Kings of Israel are mentioned 17 times.

3 Chronicles of Kings of Judah are mentioned 15 times.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C. 646 to 570 (1 Kings. 8:8, before the temple was **destroyed in B.C. 586**).

CHRIST IN 1ST KINGS

Solomon is a shadow of Christ. Wisdom, greatness, wealth, peace and worship of Christ will reveal after His return in glory and every one will know that He is greater than Solomon.

Elijah is shadow of Christ. His prophesy, miracle healing, etc are shadow Christ in him.

MAIN TOPIC Reign of Solomon, divided kingdom, Kings, prophets and leadership.

OBSERVATION OF THE BOOK

About half of the 1st Kings is history of Solomon. The wisest man lived on the face of earth took Israel to the peak of its glory. The kingdom was divided into two after his death. Chapter 1 to 11 is one Kingdom and then 12 to 22 is the divided Kingdom.

ONE KINGDOM (CHAPTER 1 – 11)

Wisdom, greatness, wealth and faithfulness of Solomon are unequal. His half brother, Adonijah, started to be the king even before David died. As advised by Prophet Nathan Solomon was anointed as king. Solomon started marrying gentile women and his heart departed from God. Because of his wisdom and ability, the kingdom expanded to the borders of Babylon and Egypt.

The main reason for the greatness of Solomon is that he built the temple of God. At the dedication of the temple, his prayer brought

the people and himself closer to God. His wealth paved way for the deterioration of the kingdom. He built heathen temples for his gentile wives. The wisest man became most foolish at his old age. God judged Solomon for his actions. Only a portion of the Kingdom that he ruled was under the reign of his heirs (only Judah).

DIVIDED KINGDOM

After Solomon's death judgment of God came upon the kingdom. His son was foolish and he increased taxes. The people rebelled and 10 tribes joined Jeroboam and 2 tribes joined Rehoboam. Thus the kingdom was divided in to two. Then these two kingdoms became enemies to each other and there were constant wars between them. Jeroboam's people became idol worshippers. All the Kings names are in the book. Prophet Elijah was ministering during reign of King Ahab. Ahab wanted to convert vineyard of Naboth to vegetable garden. Ahab was killed because he disobeyed the prophet of God, Miccaiah. The book comes to an end with Jehoshaphat, King of Judah and Ahaziah, king of Israel.

There are 22 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. Why is Solomon's reign known as the golden period of Israel?
2. In Latin Vulgate how is 1st Samuel to 2nd Kings divided?
3. How long did the Kings ruled? How many kings ruled in each of the divided kingdom?
4. What are the reasons of deterioration of Solomon's kingdom?
5. Why it is believed that the author of Kings is Jeremiah?
6. What are other books that the author used for writing the book?
7. How long is the writing period? Explain.
8. Make an observation about 1st Kings.
9. What is the main message in the book of 1st Kings?

LESSON 12

2 KINGS

PURPOSE: To know that God hates idol worship. God rejected Judah and Israel, both divided Kingdoms, as they rejected the true God. They were given up to slavery and oppression.

Memory verses:
2 Kings 17:22, 23 & 23:27

The people of Israel walked in all the since which Jeroboam did; they did not depart from them, until the Lord remove Israel out of his sight, and he had spoken by all his servants the prophts. So Israel was exiled from their own land to Assyria until this day.

And the Lord said, "I will remove Judah also out of my sight, as I have remove Israel, I will cast off this city which I have chosen, Jerusalem and the house of which I said, My name shall be there.

INTRODUCTION

2nd Kings is a continuation of 1st Kings. In 2nd Kings there are 12 Kings in the Northern Kingdom and 16 Kings in the Southern kingdom. The reign of these kings are as follows:

United Kingdom	112 years
Israel Kingdom (divided)	209 years
Reign of Judah in excess of Israel	136 years
Total reign of Kings	457 years

The Northern Kingdom which is known as Israel was destroyed by Assyrians in B.C. 721. The Southern Kingdom which is known as Judah was destroyed by Babylonians in B.C.600. Prophet Elijah and Elisha ministered among the people. Prophet Amos and Hosea also ministered in the northern Kingdom. Obadiah, Joel, Isaiah, Micah, Nahum, Zephaniah, Jeremiah and Habakkuk are prophets who ministered in the southern kingdom. During this period Ahab, Ahaziah, Joram, Jehu, Jehoahaz and Joash ruled as Kings.

1st and 2nd Kings were originally one book. This book comes to an end as the Kingdom of Judah was destroyed by Babylon. There were 19 ungodly kings in Israel and 20 kings in Judah. Some of the kings in Judah feared God which is why the kingdom existed slightly longer than the other kingdom. The author is focusing on the tragic end of both kingdoms.

AUTHOR

Jeremiah or one of his contemporary prophets may have written this book. The style of writing is similar to Jeremiah. The author left out the ministry of Jeremiah during the reign of Josiah and his descendants probably because it is already written in Jeremiah. The history after the Babylonian exile is probably not written by Jeremiah. It is written in Jer. 43:1-8, that he ran away to Egypt.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C.550

The incident at the end of 2nd Kings (25:27-30) about Jehoiachin took place in B.C. 560. So the book was written after that.

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

From Ahaziah to Hosea, the reign of the Kings of Israel is 160 years. After that Kings Judah ruled for 136 years. In total Judah existed for 296 years. Therefore the total period of writing is about 400 years.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF 2ND KINGS

Jesus Christ came to this world through the Kingdom or lineage of Judah. Elijah is a shadow of Christ. His ministry of mercy, love, grace and hope are a shadow of Christ.

MAIN TOPIC

The influence of rulers over the people and the result of the same. Ministry of prophets like Elijah and Elisha.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

The greatness of the United Kingdom of Israel was destroyed by dividing the kingdom. The divided kingdoms were destroyed by the Assyrians (Israel) and Babylonians (Judah). The history of the divided Kingdoms are recorded in the first 17 chapters of the book. The history of Judah is documented in chapters 18 to 25.

HISTORY OF DIVIDED KINGDOM (1-17)

The history of the wicked kings of Israel and the history of Judah are the subjects under discussion. The ministry of Elijah and Elisha including their miracle work and exhortation did not illicit any revival in Israel. They did not completely give up idol worship or start worshipping the true God. While Elijah did the ministry of judgment, Elisha was in the ministry of encouraging and helping. The people however rejected both prophets.

Elijah got Jehu anointed as Kings through his disciples. Jehu killed the descendents of Ahab, according to the instruction of the prophets. Ahab's wife Jezebel, his sons, daughters, and the prophets of Bal were all killed. Despite this they did not stop idol worship. After the time of Ahab both Israel and Judah became weak and their enemies started to attack them. In Judah the daughter of Jezebel, Athaliah, started to kill descendents of David, except Joash. Then Joash became the King.

Joash repaired the Temple and started worship. As time went by Kings and the people who had no fear of God did not repent of their wicked ways. During the period of King Jeroboam II, there

was a slight spiritual revival. After that, during the reign of the wicked Kings, the kingdom came under the Assyrians.

KINGDOM OF JUDAH

19 Kings from 9 tribes ruled in Israel. 8 of them became King by assassinating the previous king. None of them were good in the sight of God. But in Judah only one tribe ruled. Out of 20 Kings, 18 of them did what was right in the sight of God. The history of Judah ends with Babylonian captivity. Six years before Israel came under the rule of Assyria, Hezekiah became King of Judah. Because of his faith, God protected Jerusalem from the attack of the Assyrians. Subsequently however, the son of Hezekiah, Manasseh became an idol worshipper and the kingdom started to deteriorate. Even though his follower, Josiah, tried to revive the kingdom there was not much improvement. After that 4 kings ruled the kingdom. Since they were wicked the judgment of God came upon them. They became captives three times. The third time Nebuchadnezzar destroyed the Temple. With a small remnant the book of 2nd Kings come to an end.

There are 25 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

- 1 How many kings are recorded history of Israel and Judah are in this book?
Name them.
- 2 How long did the reign of the Kings extended? Explain.
- 3 What are similarities between the book of Jeremiah and 2nd Kings?
- 4 How long is the period of writing? Explain.
- 5 Explain the shadow of Christ in this book.
- 6 Give an observation about the book with a focus on the end of both the kingdoms.

LESSON 13

I CHRONICLES

PURPOSE: The reign of David and his fame were suitable for the genealogy of Son of God. We should be grateful to our God as well as David.

Memory verses:

I Chronicles 17:11-14 & 29:11

All these were the sons of Jediael according to the heads of their fathers houses, mighty warriors, seventeen thousand and two hundred, ready for service in war. And Shuppim and Huppim were the sons of Ir, Hushim the sons of Aher. The sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni, Jezer and Shallum, the offspring of Bilhah. The sons of Manasseh: Asriel, whom his Aramean concudine bore; she bore Machir the father of Gilead.

Thine, O Lord, is the greatness, and the power, and glory, and the victory, and the majesty; for all that is in the heavens and in the earth is thine; thine is the kingdom, O Lord, and thou art exalted as head above all.

INTRODUCTION

The first 12 Books of the Old Testament were written during a period when the people of Judah were in slavery. The books of Chronicles is really a repetition of these past Books. The main subject of this book are the Kings of Judah, especially David. This Book is related more to the information presented in the books of Samuel. The first 9 chapters record the individual history of the forefathers from Adam to the period of exile.

This book is not simply a repetition. Instead, a detailed history of David and Saul are added in this book. We do not see the dark records of the histories of David and Saul in this Book, but instead only the virtues. The books of Kings describe the history of the Kings of Israel and Judah in detail. In contrast, the books of Chronicles only describe the history of the Kings of Judah.

Through their history, we can see many qualities concerning the relationship between God and his people. It gives us the history of David's lineage, the history of Jesus' family heritage and the written history of recapture.

I and II Chronicles are mentioned as one book in the Hebrew Bible. But the Septuagint translation divided it into two books. In Hebrew, the books of Chronicles are added at the end. While I and II Kings and the books of Samuel describe the political matters of Israel and Judah, the books of Chronicles describe their spiritual and religious matters. The writer (Samuel) presents the books of Samuel and Kings like a prophet. In contrast, the writer of the books of Chronicles had a priestly viewpoint (Ezra is the writer who was a priest). After showing the majestic records of David, it expounds on the importance of the spiritual righteousness of David.

The Hebrew name of the books of Chronicles is 'Divre (Dibere) Hayyamim'. The meaning of this word is 'the day by day historic events'. When the Septuagint separated the books of Chronicles they called it Paralipomenon which means 'things left out'. Some of the historical events from the Books of Samuel and Kings are omitted. Some call this Basileon Louda or history of Judah. The Latin word *Chronicorum Liber* means Chronicles of History. The English word Chronicles is actually derived from this Latin word.

AUTHOR:

I and II Chronicles are the continuation of Ezra and Nehemiah. Jewish Tradition gives credit for the writing these Books to Ezra. These books are official records of each year's reign of the various Kings. The books mention other sources which aided the author

in the writing of the books of Chronicles. Those sources include: David's Chronicles (1 Chronicles 27:24), the book of Prophet Samuel, the books of Prophet Nathan, the book of Ahijah the Shilonite, the book of prophet Eddo (2 Chronicles 13:22), the Annals of Jeshu the son of Hanani, the treatise of the book of the Kings (2 Chronicles 24:27), the Acts of Uzziah, the prophet Isaiah (2 Chronicles 26: 22), visions of Isaiah (2 Chronicles 32:32), the Book of the King of Israel and Judah (2 Chronicles 32:32), records of Hozai (2 Chronicles 33:19).

In addition, other unknown books and diaries were helpful in the writing of the books of Chronicles. The writer had great knowledge of the Old Testament books which helped him to repeat the divine books of the Old Testament.

God used Ezra to write this book not only because of his knowledge of the history of his times, but also to benefit the entire world at all times. Recall, the reign of Judah ended with the Babylonian exile after Saul. During exile, Ezra may have written this book regarding priesthood and the worship of Jehovah as the main themes. As a priest, Ezra's writing style in the books of Chronicles resembles the book of Ezra. The concluding verses of 2 Chronicles 36:22, 23 are similar to Ezra 1:1-3. Even the descriptions are alike in these two books.

Ezra was a scribe who was skilled in the Law of Moses (Ezra 7:6). It is believed that Nehemiah may have possibly collected all of the books and gave them to Ezra. Ezra speaks of these books in this books of 1st Chronicles. These books may have been from historians of that historical period. The books of Chronicles can be a book of combined books in a divine way.

PERIOD OF WRITING (B. C 450-400)

The people recorded in these books are not in the genealogy mentioned after B.C 400. For this reason the book of Ezra and Chronicles are believed to be written during the same period (1 Chronicles 3:17-24).

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

Chapters 1-9 describe the genealogy from Adam to David. Chapter 10 describes the history of Saul. Chapters 11-29 describe how David ruled over all the Israelites for about 33 years.

CHRIST IN 1 CHRONICLE.

Jesus Christ is the successor of King David's dynasty (2King 7). The northern kingdom (Israel) was ruled by 9 Kings of different tribes. The southern kingdom (Judah) was ruled by the same Dynasty. Even though Queen Anthelia attempted to destroy the whole dynasty of David, God left a remnant from them. This is how Jesus was born as a son of David.

John the Baptist was the forerunner of Jesus just as Elijah was the forerunner of Elisha. While Elijah's ministry was the ministry of judgment, Elisha's ministry was full of sympathy and mercy that lived among the people. Elijah's prime cause was to expound on the Law of God, while in contrast Elisha's prime cause was to expound on the Law of Grace. Similarly, Christ and Elijah are identical with the Law of God. We can see the concepts of the kingdom, worship and the Messiah are all revealed through the history of Judah's lineage (Genesis 49:10).

MAIN TOPIC:

This book provides a historic view from Adam to David as well as the history of Saul and the unique and exemplary history of David.

OBSEVATION ABOUT THE BOOK:

The kingdom of Israel was destroyed and removed from history by Assyria (2 Kings 17). David is portrayed in this book as a model king of Judah, the kingdom destroyed by Babylon (2 Kings 25). This book can be divided into two sections:

1. David's royal dynasty: Chapters 1-9
2. David's exemplary ruling period: chapters 10-29

DAVID'S ROYAL DYNASTY (1-9)

The first 9 chapters of I Chronicles describe genealogy. A unique aspect of this book is that the history of Judah is written in this book by focusing specifically on David. This book reveals God's love and consideration towards his beloved people through the history of Judah. God works throughout the centuries to keep His promises and the covenant made with David.

THE EVENTS OF DAVID'S EXEMPLARY RULING PERIOD (10-29)

The David we see in 2nd Samuel is different in nature than the David of 1 Chronicles. In 1st Chronicles David has a special light in him. We can see that some information from the previous history has been excluded or added later. Some excluded information includes the fight between Saul and David, his 7 years of reign in Hebron, and the history of the different Queens of many tribes. They also left out the competition of Absalom and the affair of David with Bathsheba. The books of Chronicles is written with the intention of favoring David. This book is focused on highlighting the concepts of grace and mercy. Additional topics not mentioned in 2nd Samuel were added to this book to encourage those who came back from captivity. For example, David's preparation of building the Temple or House of God and preparation for worship are not seen in 2nd Samuel.

The history of Saul is only mentioned in I Chronicles 10. The reason might be because Saul's heart was not right with the Lord. That history begins with the anointing of David as King of Israel. In this book the writer describes David's courage, dedication and unity. David's interest and dedication to bring the Ark of the Lord and to build the House of the Lord are very remarkable through these chapters. Chapter 17 repeats the covenant of God with David. David's victories, his expansion of the territories and his nobility of David are seen in chapters 18-20. David numbering of Israel however displeased God. The importance of a priest's involvement in building the Temple of God provides evidence of the vision of a Priest as the author of this book. Nevertheless,

God did not give permission to David to build the House of the Lord (28:3). However the size of the Temple of God, the storing materials, tools and equipment, preparing the place to build the Temple, appointing Levites, musicians, singers, porters, overseers and army divisions are all included in David's plans for the Temple. 1st Chronicles conclude with David entrusting the building of the House of the Lord to his son Solomon with a sincere prayer and praising the glorious name of God. The Book of 1st Chronicles has 28 chapters.

QUESTIONS

1. Why did the author of I Chronicles leave out the history of the Kings of Israel?
2. Why is this book believed to have a vision of a priest?
3. What are the other names of this book in different Languages? Explain the meaning of each name.
4. What evidence is there that shows that the author used other books to write the books of Chronicles?
5. Explain who the author is with proper logic and reason.
6. When was this book written? How many years did it take to complete this book?
7. Explain how Christ is revealed in Chronicles.
8. Prepare a summary of the vision of this book.

LESSON 14

2 CHRONICLES

PURPOSE; Blessing and prosperity depend upon obedience to the word of God and true worship.

Memory verses:

2 Chro. 7:14 and 16:9

If my people who are called by my name humble themselves, and pray and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin and heal their land.

For the eyes of the Lord run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to show his might in behalf of those whose heart is blameless toward him. You have done foolishly in this; for from now on you will have wars.

INTRODUCTION:

Chronicles speaks of the history of the Jewish kings, their reign and their rule. For forty years prior to the history recorded in this book, the Israelites lacked a physical place of worship. It was the desire of King David to finally build a temple of God where the people could have one place to worship. God spoke directly to David and gave him instruction as to the specifications of this holy temple. As part of God's will, it was not David who would build the temple. Although David was a man after God's own heart, the blood that stained David's hands prevented him from attaining

the privilege of carrying out this project. Instead it was David's son, Solomon, who would build the Jerusalem Temple. (2 Samuel 7:5-7, 1 Chronicles 28:19, Exodus 25:9)

God rejected the kingdom of Israel because they became idol worshippers and did nothing for the construction of the Temple. According to 2 Chronicles, many kings after David, including Asa, Jehoshaphat, Joash, Hezekiah, and Josiah, were all involved in the rebuilding of the temple during the time of their respective reign. The book of 2nd Chronicles begins with a description of the beauty and sophistication in the design of the Jerusalem Temple. The book later goes on to explain the temple's destruction due to idolatry and disobedience to the word of God. Later God instructed Cyrus, the king of Persia, to rebuild the temple. Altogether, the book of 2nd Chronicles records about 400 years of history of the people of Israel.

AUTHOR:

The author of this book is explained in the previous lesson regarding the book of 1st Chronicles.

WRITING PERIOD:

This book was written in the 5th century BC (450 - 400).

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD:

2 Chronicles 1-9 (BC 971-939; 40 years)

2 Chronicles 10-36 (BC 931-538; 393 years)

Total of 433 years

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF NUMBERS (shadow of Christ)

After the rule of King David, Israel was a very peaceful kingdom. There was no crime, slavery, war, or poverty; everything was perfect just like the kingdom of the Messiah. In Matthew 12:6 it states, "yet I say to you, that in this place, there is one greater than the temple". In John 2:19, and Revelation 21:22, Jesus compares his body to the temple of Jerusalem (temple of the Lamb).

MAIN TOPIC:

The history of the Kingdom of Judah, its growth and destruction.

OBSERVATIONS ABOUT THE BOOK

This book explains that if you disobey and turn away from God, He will also turn away from you. This book is divided in two time periods:

- 1 The kingdom of Solomon (chapters 1-9).
- 2 The kingdom of all other kings of Judah (10-36).

REIGN OF SOLOMON:

This time was also known as the Golden years of Judah. There was health, wealth, peace and happiness all throughout the land during the chapters that cover this era. It speaks more of the Kingdom of God than the kingdom of Solomon.

REIGN OF OTHER KINGS OF JUDAH:

After the death of Solomon the kingdom started to slowly perish and turned more to idolatry rather than the word of God. Some of the kings mentioned from these chapters turned to God, but some did not. There were eight good kings and twelve evil kings. The reign of each king is assessed by their relationship to the temple.

The 20 kings of Judah:

1. Rehoboam. He was not a God fearing person but chose to submit himself to God so his kingdom was spared. (12:12)
2. Abijah . He helped some of his kingdom come to God and his kingdom was able to overthrow Israel. (13:18)
3. Asa. He removed all of the idols and rebuilt the temple; he won over the country of Ethiopia
4. Jehoshaphat. He spoke against idolatry and prompted true worship amongst the people.

5. Jehoram. He was a wicked King that took after the ways of king Ahab. He married the daughter of Ahab and encouraged the worship of idols.
6. Ahaziah and Athaliah. Ahaziah was as evil a king as his father. He and his mother, Athaliah, were killed during the rule of their kingdom.
8. Joash. He repaired the temple of Jerusalem and returned worship to the temple. However, following the death of Jehoiada the priest, he turned away from the will of God.
9. Amaziah. He initially worshiped both the living God and idols. But soon he followed the God of Edom. Subsequently the King of Israel defeated his kingdom and he was killed.
10. Uzziah. He spent some time worshipping the living God, but after winning major military victories for his kingdom, pride overwhelmed him and he began worshipping idols.
11. Jotham. He rebuilt the temple and worshipped God. He was granted victory over his enemies.
12. Ahaz. He was an evil King who only worshipped idols. To keep his enemies from attacking his kingdom, he gave them all treasures from the temple.
13. Hezekiah. He removed the idols from the temple and made a call for the return of true worship. God saved him from the Assyrians.
14. Manasseh. He was the most wicked king at that time. He placed idols all throughout his land. He was taken away by the Assyrians. Later he repented of his ways and returned to Judah. Amon, his son became the king of Judah and followed in the footsteps of his father's evil ways. The enemies of Manasseh killed both father and son.
16. Josiah - He walked in the will of God and reignited true worship throughout the land.

17. 18. and 19. Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, and Jehoiachia - All three kings ruled in wicked ways, allowing for their kingdom to be taken into captivity by their enemies.

20. Zedekiah - He was the last king of Judah. During his reign, Babylon had taken over the land and destroyed all they had as well taken the people into captivity.

This book concludes with Cyrus taking over rule and rebuilding the temple. There are 36 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. Who are the good kings of Judah? How many years did they reign?
2. How many years did it take to write this book?
3. What similarities are there between the temple and Christ?
4. How is the kingdom of David similar to the kingdom of Christ?
5. Discuss the geographical history during the reign of Solomon.
6. What is the hope at end of captivity?
7. Write an overview of the book of 1st Chronicle.

LESSON 15

EZRA

PURPOSE God will fulfill the promises He made. People of God must study the word of God and live according to the word. They should be ready to teach and preach the word.

Memory verses:

Ezra. 1:2, 7:10.

“Thus says Cyrus king of Persia: The LORD, the God of heaven, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth, and he has charged me to build him a house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah.

For Ezra had set his heart to study the law of the LORD, and to do it, and to teach his statutes and ordinances in Israel.

INTRODUCTION

The word Ezra means help. Ezra, Nehemiah and Esther are the last historical books in the Old Testament. These books reveal the history of the people returning from Babylonian captivity to the homeland. This includes a description of the reconstruction of the Temple, construction or repair of the wall of the city of Jerusalem and the life of the Jewish people in their homeland. This book accounts for a time period of about 100 years. During this period the prophets Haggai, Zechariah and Malachi ministered among the people.

We may divide this era into 2 specific periods. During B.C.536 to 516 (20 years) the governor Zerubbabel and the priest Joshua began building the Temple (Ezra chapter 3-6). Haggai, Zachariah and Malachi were prophets during this period. From B.C. 457 to

432 (25 years) Nehemiah and Ezra joined together in building the wall of the city. Jerusalem became a walled city again. Ezra reveals the history of both these eras. Nehemiah reveals only the history of the second era. The story of Esther happens between these two periods. In Nehemiah, the Jewish people come back from captivity 3 times.

1 In B.C. 536 Zerubbabel and his group

2 In B.C. 457 with Priest Ezra

3 In B.C. 444 with Nehemiah

In B.C. 606 Judah went to captivity in Babylon. They returned to Jerusalem after 70 years just as the Prophet Jeremiah prophesied in Babylon. The King of Persia, Cyrus, gave the proclamation for the Jewish people to go back when Cyrus had conquered Babylon. The land of Persia spanned from east of the river Euphrates and Tigris to Greece. The capital cities were Susa and Persapolis. The Kings at times lived in Babylon.

From Cyrus to Darius III (B.C. 539 to 331), 12 Emperors reigned Persia. In B.C. 231 Alexander the Great conquered Persia and the Greek Empire came into existence.

Some important persons.

B.C. 538 (1) Cyrus.	Sent Jewish people back to Jerusalem. Rebuilding of Temple.
B.C. 529-522 (2) Artaxerxes (Cambeses)	During the time of Ezra (Ezra. 4:7-11)
B.C. 521 -485 (3) Darius I.	Completed the reconstruction of the Temple (Ezra. 6:1).
B.C. 485-465 (4) Xerxes	initiates war with Greece and Esther become his wife.
B.C. 465-425 (5) Artaxerxes I.	Appointed Nehemiah as Governor and gave him the responsibility of rebuilding the wall of the city.

B.C.423-405 (6) Darius II. Zechariah became Governor.

B.C. 331 (7) Darius III. Alexander the Great won and established the Greek Empire.

2nd Chronicle 36:22, 23 is the beginning of the book of Ezra. Daniel interpreted the writing on the wall and Babylon became part of the Persian Empire. Daniel read to Darius from Jeremiah 25:11, 12. 29:10, Isaiah 44:26-28, 45:1, 13 and that encouraged the king to make a declaration of freedom for those in captivity.

Ezra was involved in rebuilding the Temple and Nehemiah was involved in the rebuilding the wall of the city. Both books establish the genealogy from the Priesthood of Aaron. The book of Ezra and Nehemiah conclude with repentance, prayer and turning the people's hearts toward the Lord. The ministries of Haggai and Zachariah may have helped them.

Some call this the second exodus of Israel. From Egypt all of Israel came out but from Babylon only those who wanted to come out willfully came out.

Ezra is the Aramaic form of the Hebrew name Ezer. The Septuagint translation calls it Esdras Deuteron or two Ezras. In Latin the book is known as Liber Primus Esdras. It is also known as the 1st book of Ezra. Nehemiah is known as the 2nd book of Ezra.

AUTHOR

According to Jewish tradition, the books of 1st and 2nd Chronicles, Ezra and Nehemiah were all written by Ezra. This is supposed to be a continuous story. The words "I, My, Our" in this book establish the authorship of Ezra.

Ezra's priestly lineage is established in this book as well. Ezra is the 16th generation from Aaron. Ezra was very familiar with the scriptures. Nehemiah's diary was also helpful to Ezra in writing these books. It is believed that Ezra is the one who established the Synagogue. The history of Esther happens between the 6th and 7th chapter of Ezra.

PERIOD OF WRITING: B.C. 430 to 400

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

B.C. 538 – 515	People of captivity come back to Jerusalem (49,897 people).
B.C. 483 – 473	2nd group returned came back under the leadership of Ezra (1754 people). Ezra 7-10
B.C. 44 – 425	Nehemiah. 3rd group returned. About 110 years history. The history of Ezra alone is 31 years.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF EZRA

God who promised David the everlasting throne, fulfilled His word through Christ. Just as the remnant people were brought back to the promised land, Christ will take us to the promised land. Like Ezra brought forth in his time, restoration and forgiveness is given by Christ. Both Christ and Ezra are connected with Bethlehem, Jerusalem and Zion.

MAIN TOPIC

Return from exile, reconstruction of the Temple, and spiritual restoration are the main topics.

OBSERVATION OF THE BOOK

As seen in Jeremiah 29:10-14, the book describes how God brought His people back. Even though the glory of God departed them, the presence of God was with them. God will not abandon His children.

The book of Ezra includes the history of the people returning to Jerusalem from exile, the reconstruction of the Temple, and spiritual revival.

In Chapters 1-6, the 1st group returned from exile to Jerusalem.

In Chapters 7-10, the next group under the leadership of Ezra returned (B.C. 457).

RETURN AND CONSTRUCTION OF THE TEMPLE

(CHAPTERS 1 TO 6)

Cyrus defeated Babylon in B.C.539 and the kingdom came under the rule of Persia. In B.C. 539 the exiled Jews were permitted to go back to Jerusalem. Isaiah prophesied about Cyrus about 200 years before these events occurred. It is possible that due to this very prophesy, Cyrus permitted Jews to return.

There were about 3,00,00,000 Jewish people in Babylon. Only 49897 returned to Jerusalem. Most of them liked the life in Babylon. This was probably because of the 900 mile journey they would have to endure to reach the homeland and the problems associated with rebuilding the Temple. In the group that left were people among the the tribes of Judah, Benjamin, and Levi as well as representatives of the other 10 tribes.

Like Zerubbabel, those who returned first built the altar, then feasted, and after they began to build the Temple.

In B.C. 536 a foundation for the Temple was laid. From B.C. 534 to 520 there were obstacles to continue the building process. Darius II gave permission to build the Temple and it was finished in B.C. 515.

SPIRITUAL REVIVAL

(CHAPTER 7 TO 10)

Once Zerubbabel returned a small group came back to Jerusalem along with Ezra. Artaxerxes gave permission to Ezra, and so it became possible to receive offerings and gifts in order to build the Temple. Only some Priests and some people from the tribe of Levi came back with Ezra (2:36,-42, 8:15-19). The offerings and gifts received were given to 12 Levi leaders for safe keeping. When the group reached Jerusalem they received back these offering and gifts back from the Levites (8:15-22).

Ezra brought the people back to the commandments of God. He offered intercessory prayer for the people and the people repented and gave up their evil ways. Therefore there was a revival among them.

There are 10 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

- 1 What are the three returns in the book of Ezra and who were the leaders?
 - 2 How are the books of Ezra, Nehemiah and Esther connected historically?
 - 3 What is relation between the last verse in 2nd Chronicles and starting verses of Ezra?
 - 4 Why are Ezra and Nehemiah called 1st Ezra and 2nd Ezra?
 - 5 How can we prove the author is Aaron's descendent?
 - 6 Describe the writing period and history of that period.
 - 7 How is Zerubbabel a shadow of Christ?
- — — — —

LESSON 16

NEHEMIAH

PURPOSE: God was faithful toward the exiles. Many people were used to help them, to deliver them and to restore them. Specifically Nehemiah's prayer, patience, patriotism, courage, leadership, and selflessness were vital and qualities to be imitated.

Memory verses:

Nehemiah 6:15, 16 & 8:8

So the wall was finished on the twenty-fifth day of the month Elul, in fifty-two days. And when all our enemies heard of it, all the nations round about us were afraid and fell greatly in their own esteem; for they perceived that this work had been accomplished with the help of our God.

And they read from the book, from the law of God, clearly; and they gave the sense, so that the people understood the reading.

INTRODUCTION:

Nehemiah means 'consoled by God'. It had been hundreds of years since the Jews entered their own land, Jerusalem. After rebuilding of the temple in Jerusalem, the Jews gradually acquired prosperity. The city of Jerusalem still remained as a city without walls. The opposition and accusations were great against the building of the wall of Jerusalem. However, the Kings of Persia were more lenient towards the Jews of Jerusalem than the Kings of Babylon. Nehemiah was the cupbearer to King Artaxerxes. Queen Esther was the wife of Xerxes, the father of King Artaxerxes. Her influence and authority also came in favor toward the people of Jerusalem. The trustworthy cupbearer Nehemiah, was sent to Jerusalem as an authoritative figure (governor), with an order to rebuild the wall of Jerusalem. Prayer, patience, modesty/humbleness, courage, leadership and or loyalty toward one's own land or country are all necessary aspects one needs to have in possession to be on such a mission. After four months of fasting, praying and knowing what God had placed in his heart, Nehemiah decided to present and expound on his mission in the presence of the king. (Four months from Kislev to Nisan).

Jewish months:

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| 1. Tishre | 7. Nisan |
| 2. Heshvan | 8. Sivan |
| 3. Kislev | 9. Iyar |
| 4. Tebeth | 10. Tammuz |
| 5. Shebat | 11. Ab |
| 6. Adar | 12. Elul |

(Jewish temple calendar Nisan (Abib) is considered as first month of the year) Ezra and Nehemiah lived in the same time period. Nehemiah and his people remained in Babylon till the end of captivity. Despite opposition and accusations from within and outside the group, the wall of Jerusalem was built and completed within fifty-two remarkable days. The Jewish people grew spiritually

and in other ways during this period of opposition. Nehemiah remained the governor in Jerusalem from 444 B.C to 432 B.C. The Hebrew name for this book is Nehemia. When Ezra and Nehemiah were considered one book in Greek, they started referring it as ***Esdras Deuteron***. In Latin, it received the name ***Liber Secundus Ezras*** meaning, the second book of Ezra. Eventually however it was called ***Liber Nehemiah***, the book of Nehemiah.

AUTHOR

It is very clear that the majority of this book is written from the memory of Nehemiah (Nehemiah 1:1, 7:5, 12:27-43, 13:4-31). It can therefore be concluded that this book is solely written by Nehemiah himself.

Nevertheless, there is evidence that points toward Ezra as possible author of this book as well. (Nehemiah 7:6-12:26, 12:44-13:3). There are people who believe that Ezra gathered Nehemiah's diary writings and letters and then wrote the book. Nehemiah 7:5-73 and Ezra 2:1-70 give the impression that someone recollected or gathered the information from other manuscripts or documents.

PERIOD OF WRITING

There were two Kings during that period in which Ezra was written. It was written during the time of King Artaxerxes 1 (464-422 B.C.). Esther was the step-mother of King Artaxerxes.

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

Nehemiah came from Babylon to Jerusalem in 444 B.C. Until B.C. 425, he stayed in Jerusalem. It's believed that 19 years' worth of history is part of this book.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF NEHEMIAH

Ezra and Nehemiah show their mission for restoration. Just as Nehemiah sacrificed his high status and position to serve his people,

Christ Jesus came down to this sinful world as a man sacrificing his Godliness and His holiness to save people from eternal damnation. Just as Nehemiah took the responsibility and accomplished everything, Christ finished everything that God the Father wanted Him to do. Nehemiah restored everything except the King, however one can see the shadow of the Messiah in this book.

MAIN TOPIC

The rebuilding of the temple, followed by the purification of the people, the rebuilding of the walls and the third wave of returning exiles are the main topics of this book.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

Nehemiah's mission has a very close relationship and bonding with Ezra's mission. While Ezra deals with religious restoration of Judah, Nehemiah is primarily concerned with political and geographical restoration. Ezra and Nehemiah combine to make an effective team in rebuilding the postexilic remnant. Malachi, the last Old Testament prophet, also ministers during this time to provide additional moral and spiritual direction. There are two major divisions (1) the reconstruction of Wall (1-7), (2) the restoration of the people (8-13).

REBUILDING OF THE WALL JERUSALEM

Nehemiah's love and care toward Jerusalem and his own people, made him take some bold steps. The wall of Jerusalem was destroyed by King Nebuchadnezzar in 586 B.C. And later in 464 B.C. with the order from the ruler of Persia King Artaxerxes 1 (Ezra 4:6-23), the wall was rebuilt. However, during the time of opposition and accusations Nehemiah prayed to the God to receive the order, protection and assistance from King Artaxerxes to rebuild the wall of Jerusalem.

The return of the exiles under the provision of Nehemiah took place in 444 B.C. This was thirteen years after the return of the exiles under the provision of Ezra and ninety-four years after the

return of exiles under the provision of Zerubbabel. After inspecting the wall of Jerusalem, Nehemiah told people “Let us rise up and build” (Nehemiah 2:18). Work began immediately on the wall and its gates, with people building portions corresponding to where they were living. When they saw that the work was improving greatly and going forward and the breaches were beginning to close, the surrounding people became very angry. Opposition first arose in the form of mockery against the people of Jerusalem, and thereafter they all plotted together to come and fight against Jerusalem. Nehemiah overcame this by preparing half of his servants to work on construction while the other half held spears and bows. Nehemiah had to face trouble and inconvenience within and outside of the Jerusalem. Instead of the rich Jewish leaders in Jerusalem helping their Jewish brothers, they were exploiting the poor. The wealthier Jews were taking advantage of the poorer Jews. Due to their participation in this battle, their everyday living expenses were no more. The rich abused and oppressed the poor by forcing them to mortgage their property and by saying that everything they had including their children would be enslaved under them. Everyone was affected by the famine and exploitation. Nehemiah prayed and God heard his prayers and resolved his problems. He distributed whatever he had with him to all his brothers in need and rescued all those who were under the intimidation of the rich through prayer and action. Nehemiah and his people finished the wall in 52 days. When all their enemies heard of this, they were afraid and perceived that this work had been accomplished with the help of God (6:16).

RESTORATION OF PEOPLE

After the building of the wall, Nehemiah started the work again for spiritual unity of the people of Jerusalem. Ezra the scribe stood on a wooden platform and deliberated the Law of Moses which the Lord had commanded to Israel (8-10). They translated it from Hebrew to Aramaic so that the people who were listening would understand. They stood and confessed their sins and iniquities

and pledged to obey the Laws of God. Levites and priests helped them in their prayers. They praised God for his holiness, justice, mercy, love and deliverance. The covenant was then renewed with God as the people committed themselves to separate from the Gentiles in marriage and to obey God's commandments. Leaders of the people, 1/10 of the people, and some Priests stayed in Jerusalem and the remainder lived outside the city. The reconstructed walls of Jerusalem were dedicated to God in a joyful ceremony.

Unfortunately, Ezra's revival was short-lived. Nehemiah returned to Persia in 432 B.C.(13:6) and made a second trip to Jerusalem in about 425 B.C. to revive the people. He cleaned the temple, enforced the observance of Sabbath and forced people to remove their heathen wives. In this book there are 13 chapters.

QUESTIONS

1. What are unique characteristics of Nehemiah's personality?
2. List reasons why Nehemiah found favor in the sight of King Artaxerxes?
3. Write the Hebrew Months in order.
4. Create your idea of the Wall of Jerusalem.
5. What is the meaning of *Liber SecundusEzras*?
6. Explain the authorship of the book of Nehemiah.
7. How are Christ and Nehemiah similar?
8. Nehemiah was not only concerned about the rebuilding of the Wall of Jerusalem but also the restoration of the people. Explain.
9. How many years of history are described in the book of Nehemiah?

LESSON 17

ESTHER

PURPOSE God preserves and delivers his people. He controls history according to his will.

Memory verses:

Esther 4:14 & 8:17

For if you keep silence at such a time as this, relief and deliverance will rise for the Jews from another quarter, but you and your father's house will perish. And who knows whether you have not come to the kingdom for such a time as this?

And in every province and in every city, wherever the king's command and his edict came, there was gladness and joy among the Jews, a feast and a holiday. And many from the people of the country declared themselves Jews, for the fear of the Jews had fallen upon them.

INTRODUCTION

The Jews returned to Jerusalem from Babylon in B.C.536. Construction of the temple was from BC 536 to 516. Esther became Queen of Persia in BC 478. Esther saved the Jews from genocide in BC 473. Ezra came to Babylon in BC 457. Construction of the city wall by Nehemiah was in BC 444.

The history of Esther began about 40 years after the construction of the temple and 30 years before the construction

of the wall by Nehemiah. Even though this was added in the Bible after Nehemiah, the incident of Esther took place before Nehemiah. The event of Esther becoming queen of King Xerxes was considered to be one of the milestones in the history of the Jewish people. None could imagine what would have happened to the Jewish people if Queen Esther was not there. This is not just a story with high moral value, but it is a very good example of how the Jewish people were saved from destruction. If this did not happen 500 years before the birth of the Jesus Christ, the existence of the Jewish people and the redemptive work by Jesus would have been different. This would have led the world in a different direction. This story paved the way for the savior to come to the world through the courageous act of a young and beautiful Jewish girl. This incident happened in the city of Susa which was the winter capital of the Kings of Babylon. The name of Xerxes is another name for King Cyrus of Persia (BC 485-465). There are two beliefs about the banquet. Some believe that it was a preparation party to attack Greece and the other one is that he was trying to get out of depression from being defeated in the war. He was defeated in the war at Salamis against Greece in the year BC 480. This banquet led to the rejection of Queen Vashti and the subsequent crowning of Queen Esther.

Esther is a Persian name and its corresponding name in Hebrew is "Hadassah". The meaning of this word is star. It was the name of a great goddess in Babylon. Hadassah means myrtle, a plant which has a great color and great fragrance.

The word God is not found anywhere in the book of Esther, but the name of a heathen King is mentioned 150 times in this book. The words prayer and worship are also not mentioned in this book. The name of this book was not mentioned in the New Testament at all. Despite all these facts, we see God's provision in this book more than any other book.

Esther was the daughter of Abihel who was from the tribe of Benjamin. She was an orphan and was brought up by her uncle Mordecai. She was from the family of Kish that was taken as slaves by King Nebuchadnezzar.

The Hebrew name of this book is the Megilloth Esther. This means the history of Esther. This book was called Aster in Greek and known as Esther in English.

AUTHOR (UNKNOWN)

It is believed that a Jewish person who knew King Xerxes, the culture and practices of both the people in the city of Susa and the exile Jews wrote this book after the death of Xerxes. (10:2.3). Since it is written in past tense, the book was likely written by Mordecai, or one of his contemporaries such as Ezra or Nehemiah. The writing style of this book however is different from Ezra and Nehemiah (9:10).

PERIOD OF WRITING

King Xerxes ruled during the period BC 486-464. Queen Esther was chosen in BC 483- 473 (ten years). The death of King Xerxes was in 464. It is believed that book was written before B.C. 425.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF ESTHER

Esther was ready to suffer and die for her people. Christ also suffered died for the redemption of His people and to give life. Esther interceded to the King for her people. Jesus Christ is doing the same with God the Father for his people. Like the enemy fighting against the Jewish people, Satan is always fighting with the people of God. Christ always rescues His people from Satan as He did in the past.

MAIN TOPIC The provision of God leads us to victory.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

The history of Esther took place between chapters 6 and 7 of the book of Ezra. The story of Esther took place between the first return of Jews under the leadership of Zerubbabel, and after the construction of Tabernacle when the second return took place under the leadership of Ezra.

The book may be divided into two parts.

1 Death threat against the Jewish people (chapter 1 to 4).

2 Victory of the Jewish people (chapters 5 to 10).

DEATH THREAT AGAINST JEWISH PEOPLE (1-4)

There was a banquet conducted in the capital city of Susa. All the dignitaries were invited. The King called Queen Vashti to display her beauty to these dignitaries, but Queen Vashti denied the request. The King became angry and removed her from her position. Later Esther, a young beautiful Jewish girl became the Queen with the help of her uncle Mordecai. Haman was angry at Mordecai because he would not kneel before Haman. Therefore Haman decided to kill Mordecai, his family and his people. Haman obtained a command from the King to kill all the Jewish people. Mordecai informed Esther of Haman's plot . With fasting and prayer she approached the King and informed him about Haman and his plot.

STORY OF JEWISH PEOPLE'S VICTORY

Esther arranged a banquet and invited the King and Haman. She asked Haman to come the following day also. Haman made a 75 foot tall gallows to hang Mordecai. The people of that township were eagerly awaiting to see the hanging of Mordecai. The king could not sleep that night. He was going through his diary and found that there was an incident in the past where Mordecai saved his life from the enemies. The king found that he had not given any reward to Mordecai. The King called Haman and asked what the King would give to a man whom he would like to honor. Haman had to do all that he said to Mordecai hesitantly. On the second day Haman again came to the party. The King asked Esther about her desire. She asked the King to save her and her people from being killed by Haman. The King knew about a gallows that was made by Haman. The King changed his decree and ordered that Haman and his family be hung from the same gallows that he built for Mordecai. Mordecai became minister in place of Haman. In remembrance of this incident the Jewish people celebrated the feast of Purim.

QUESTIONS

1. What is the message of the book of Esther?
 2. In what time period did the story of Esther take place? Describe the incidents which occurred before and after.
 3. Describe what would have happened if Esther did not act when she did?
 4. How did Esther become the Queen?
 5. Describe the history of Esther's family in few sentences.
 6. What are the peculiarities of the Book of Esther compared to other books in the Bible?
 7. Who was believed to be the author of book of Esther?
 8. Describe the period in which the book was written?
 9. Describe how Christ is seen in the book of Esther.
 10. Explain the day of Purim.
 11. Write an observation about the book of Esther.
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LESSON 18

JOB

PURPOSE The righteous man's sufferings are not because of his sins but to reveal God's sovereignty and His holiness.

Memory verses:

Job.13:15 & 37:23, 24

Behold, he will slay me; I have no hope; yet I will defend my ways to his face.

The Almighty - we cannot find him; he is great in power and justice, and abundant righteousness he will not violate. Therefore men fear him; he does not regard any who are wise in their own conceit.

INTRODUCTION

This book is first of the poetical-wisdom literature books. The other books in this category include Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, the Songs of Songs and Lamentations. We can see poems in other books like Exodus and Judges as well. Job, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes and Psalms 1,10, 14, 19, 37, 90 and the book of James are under the category of wisdom literature. This book is also known as a dramatic poem. This book is named after the main character, Job. Most of the poetic books were written by David and Solomon.

JOB'S FAMILY

Job is the son of Issachar, who is the son of Jacob (Gen 46: 13). He was called “Jashus” (Numb: 26; 24), from the family of the Jashuabites (1 Chro.7.1).

The book of Job is set in the period of the Patriarchs (Abraham, Isaac, Jacob and Joseph). They had not yet received the Law. There was no permanent place to worship. They only had belief in God. Satan, justice, redemption, resurrection, father and priest were all beliefs of that period.

JOB'S BIRTH PLACE

In Verses 1:1 it says that he was from the land of Uz, probably located east of Canaan. Job was believed to be a King of Edom (Gen. 36:38).

HEBREW POETRY

Most of these poems were written by David and Solomon. One of the characteristics of this Hebrew poetry is parallelism—this is when the second line reiterates the idea of the first line. The book of Job is considered one of the best in its poetic beauty.

MAIN THEME OF THE BOOK OF JOB

God does let bad things happen to good people. When bad things happen, it does not mean that God is punishing them for some sin. It is God's will that God's people are going through

hardships and sufferings at certain times in their life. Through all the suffering and trials they can see God's presence and His provision.

1. In Job's suffering he can see God's sovereignty and Holiness. He was able to see himself.
2. Job's affliction was not to destroy him but to test him to come forth as Gold (23:10).
3. God's people trusting God and serving Him was not in order to get any material blessings but to see God's glory in their life (13:15).

STORY OF A MAN WHO LOST EVERYTHING

Job lost all his wealth, family and health and wrestled with the question "why"?

The book begins with a heavenly debate between God and Satan, moves through three cycles of earthly debates between Job and his friends and concludes with a dramatic "divine diagnosis" of Job's problem. In the end Job acknowledges the sovereignty of God in his life and received back double what he had before his trials.

Iyyob is the Hebrew title for the book; this name has two possible meanings. It is derived from the Hebrew word for "persecution" and it means 'persecuted one'. It is more likely that it comes from the Arabic word meaning "to come back" or "repent". If so, it may be defined "repented one", both meanings apply to the book. The Greek title is Iob and the Latin title is also Iob.

WRITER Unknown

Some of the ancient traditional books give credit to Moses (Ex. 2:15), since Moses was in the desert of Median, which borders Edom.

Some think that Moses may have heard the story of Job or may be Job himself told Moses the story or Moses had a divine revelation of this story and wrote the book. Some even give credit to Elihu, Solomon, Isaiah and Jeremiah.

PERIOD OF WRITING B.C.1300

There are no incidents in the book to calculate the exact date, however there are some indications about the approximate date.

- 1 After his trial and restoration he lived 140 more years. His total life span was 200 years. That is equivalent to the life span of Abraham (175 years Gen. 25:7) and the patriarchs.
- 2 Wealth of a person was calculated during Job's era not with gold or silver but with cattle and slaves.
- 3 As head of the family Job, like Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, he was a Priest.
- 4 The book does not mention Israel, the Exodus, Moses, the Law and tabernacle.
- 5 The servants of Job were killed by Chaldeans (1:17), people who did not live in one place but instead were wanderers.
- 6 The Patriarchs called God "Shaddai" (Almighty), the same as seen in Job.
- 7 The name Lord (Yahweh) was being used before the time of Moses. (Ezek. 14:14 and James. 5:11 one can see Job. Therefore the book may have been written by Moses. It could have been written during the time of Solomon. The 28th chapter of Job is similar to Proverbs 8. It could have been written during the exile in Babylon. As mentioned above there are different estimates about the date.

PERIOD OF WRITING: About one year.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK OF JOB

- 1 Redeemer (19:25-27)
- 2 Mediator (9:33)
- 3 The afflictions and trials in Job should be completely satisfied in Christ (Heb 4:15)
- 4 To a believer: Christ is the redeemer and the mediator.

MAIN TOPIC

Why should a blameless upright righteous man suffer?

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

The message of this book is not about the suffering of Job, but instead what he learned during his suffering. He learned that the eyes of the Lord are upon all his creation (Phil. 2:10). The book describes a person who lived 4000 years ago who was faithful (1 to 3), righteous and repentant.

THE BOOK IS DIVIDED INTO THREE

1. The afflictions of Job (1-2)
2. Debate with Job (3-37)
3. Deliverance of Job (38-42)

JOB'S AFFLICTIONS AND TRIALS

Job was a blameless and upright man who feared God. He should not have suffered as he was faithful and unselfish. Satan falsely accused him regarding his faithfulness. Satan accuses that it is only because God had put a hedge around him that Job remained blameless and upright. God gave Satan permission to touch Job. Even though Job cursed the day of his birth, he never forsook God. (1:21-2:10).

DEBATE WITH JOB

His friends approached Job with prejudice. Without saying anything for seven days they tried to console him. Then they debated with him three times. They concluded that Job is suffering all this because of his sin. Job went to his Mediator and his advocate to submit his supplication. He had 3 reasons.

1. God is not listening to him (13:3-24, 19:7, 23:3-5, 30:20)
2. God is punishing him (6:4, 7:20, 9:17).
3. God is allowing the wicked to grow and prosper (21:7).

DELIVERANCE OF JOB (38-42)

God himself started having a debate with Job.

1. As the creator of the Universe, He showed his strength, wisdom, His protection and His provision. Then Job admitted his ignorance.

2. God showed his sovereignty. Now Job responded with his repentance. How can a man know God's ways without knowing God?

God did not say anything about Job's suffering. However, Job understood God's will. Job surrendered himself to the sovereign and divine authority of God. He prayed for his brothers, even though they were hurting him with their words. God gave Job back everything in double portion. (Except children- Why?) With Job's life, Satan was put to shame.

This book has 42 chapters.

QUESTIONS

1. Name the Poetical-wisdom Literature books. Name the wisdom Literature books?
2. Who were the authors of the poetical wisdom literature books?
3. Write a paragraph for each of the following: Job's family, birthplace and Hebrew Poets. .
4. What is main message of the book?
5. Name the probable writer of Job. Why it is believed that he is the author?
6. Why it is believed that it was written during the time of the Patriarchs?
7. Write about how Christ is reveal in the book of Job.
8. Observation about the book

LESSON 19

PSALMS

PURPOSE Spiritual songs have an important place in worship. They are as important as prayer and praise. Our body and spirit play an important role in attaining the true meaning of worship.

Memory verses:

Psalms 19:14 & 145:21

Let the words of my mouth and the meditation of my heart be acceptable in thy sight, O LORD, my rock and my redeemer.

My mouth will speak the praise of the LORD, and let all flesh bless his holy name for ever and ever.

INTRODUCTION

This is the song book of the Israelites. Prayer and praise are the main topics of this book. This book is the contribution of Israel's golden age rulers King David and Solomon. Out of 286 Old Testament quotes appearing in the New Testament, 186 are from Psalms, followed secondly by the book of Isaiah. The Psalms used in Israelite temples and synagogues are also invaluable to New Testament worshippers. This belongs in the third section of the Hebrew Bible (Kethubim, writings or songs). Among these are the books of poetry – Job, Psalms, and Proverbs. In addition, Songs of Solomon, Ruth Ecclesiastes, Lamentations and Esther belong to Scrolls or Megilloth. Other sections in the Bible are 1. Torah—the five books written by Moses, also known as Pentateuch (The Law) 2. Nebium, books of prophets.

String instruments were more commonly used. Wind instruments, the flute and trumpet and percussion instruments such as drums were also used.

Liber Psalmorum is the Latin word for Psalms – meaning book of songs. The word Psalterium is derived from psalter meaning collection of songs. There are equivalent portions in New Testament as well. (1 Corinthians 14:20, Ephesians 6:19, Colossians 3:16).

AUTHOR

73 of 150 psalms start with the heading ‘Psalm of David’.

12 Asaph’s: 50, 73-83

12 – Sons of Korah: 42-49, 84, 85, 87, 88

2 – Solomon’s: 72, 127

1 – Moses: 90

1 – Ethan: 89

50- Authors unknown. Since these 50 psalms are followed by David’s psalms, they are assumed to have been authored by David. Generally, psalms are known to be associated with David.

Some psalms were penned before David and Solomon’s birth, some before exile, and some others are related to the exile period. Most of the Psalms however were authored by David. David may have revised and expanded some of the earlier ones, since after all he was a poet and a singer. David is more famous as an author of Psalms than as a King. David’s reign was a golden age for arts and music. He was a spirit filled singer, a harpist, and a poet. David is believed to be the psalmist.

PERIOD OF WRITING From the time of Moses to Exile (1410 to 430)

CHRIST IN PSALMS:

The depiction of Christ has an important place in the book of psalms. Most of the psalms were written thousand of years before

Christ. Most of them partially mention Christ. Psalms which depict a shadow of Christ are known as Messianic Psalms (2,8,16,22,45,72. 89, 110, 118). These Psalms can be divided as follows:

1. Typical Messianic (Similar to Messianic Psalms): 34:20, 69:4,9
2. Typical Prophetic: Mentions contemporary events, but gives prophecies applicable only to Christ. Psalms 22
3. Indirectly Messianic: These Psalms mentions a king to come. It is referring to David's house, but complete fulfillment came through Christ(Psalms 2,45,72)
4. Purely Prophetic: Not suitable for the sons of David, but suitable only for Christ
5. Enthronement: Lord's reign, way of rule, and glory fulfilled only in Christ.

Messianic prophecy in Psalms & the fulfillment in New Testament

Psalms New Testament

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| 1. 1 You are my son. 2: 7 | Acts: 13: 33. Mathew 3:17 |
| 2. Put all things under his feet. 8:6 | Hebrews 2:6-10 |
| 3. Hell or bodily corruption has no authority over him. 16:10 | Acts: 2: 27, Mark16:6-7 |
| 4. Forsaken by God. 22:1 | Matthew 27:46 |
| 5. Laughed at or Scorned 22:7,8 | Matthew 27:43 Luke 23:35 |
| 6. Hands and feet pierced 22:16 | John20:25, 27 |
| 7. Cast lots for Garments 22:18 | Matthew 27:35-36
John 19:24 |
| 8. Bones not broken 34:20 | John 19:32, 33, 36 |
| 9. False Witnesses will rise up 35:11 | Mark 14:57 |
| 10. Wrongfully rejoice over him 35:19 | John 15:26 |

11. Doing the will of God 40:7	Hebrews 10:7
12. Betrayed by friends 41:9	Luke 22:47, John 13:18
13. Eternal Throne 45:6	Hebrews 1:8
14. Ascended on high 68:18	Mark 16:19
15. Zeal about God's house 69:9	John 2:17
16. Gave Gall and vinegar to drink 69:21	Mathew 27:34, 48
17. Praying for enemies 109:4	Luke 23:34
18. Betrayer will be replaced 109:8	Acts 1:20
19. Make enemies his footstool 110:1	Matthew 22:34
20. Priest forever after Melchizedek 110:4	Hebrew 5:6, 7:17
21. Cornerstone 118:22	Matthew 21:42
22. Come in the name of the Lord 118:26	Matthew 21:9

Many psalms were an inspiration to Jesus. Even at his time of death, he recited Psalms (22:1, 31:5). Resurrected Christ also recited Psalms to his disciples (Matthew 27:46, Luke 23:46, 24:44)

MAIN TOPIC Praise and worship in any circumstance

Observations about the book:

Psalms are divided into five sections. This separation is in both Hebrew and Greek. It is similar to the five books of Moses.

Book 1: 1-41

Book 2: 47-72

Book 3: 73-89

Book 4: 92-106

Book 5: 107-150

Some of these are messianic psalms. Some are historic and some are confessional and some others are supplications. Some are Hallel (praise and thanksgiving) songs while others are hallelujah (praise) songs. Psalm 119 is the longest and 117 the shortest. Psalm 118 is the middle chapter of the entire Bible and the middle verse is 118:8.

POETIC NATURE

Based on their content, psalms are named as follows.

1. Mizmor Sung with instruments – 57 psalms have this title.
2. Shir Song- Common name for hymns. 30 psalms have this title.
3. Muskin Meditation-13 psalms
4. Michtam Beautiful, elegant and meaningful – 6 psalms
5. Shiggaion Song of frenzied or emotionally disturbed – 7 psalms
6. Prayer 5 psalms

55 psalms are titled to the director of music. They oversee the music in the temple. There were leaders among temple musicians. They were believed to have gathered songs and sung during the worship.

Selah is mentioned 71 times in psalms. Selah pauses the music and gives the worshippers time to think about the message in the music.

Musical Notes in Psalms

- 1 Gittith (8, 81, 84)
- 2 Jeduthun
- 3 Death of the son (9)
- 4 Doe of the morning (22)
- 5 Tune of the Lilies (45, 69)
- 6 Tune of a Dove of a distant oaks (56)
- 7 Tune of “do not destroy” (57, 58, 59, and 75)

Some psalms make mention of musical instruments – lyre, flute, lute. Song of the ascension psalms 120 to 134, may be sung while climbing up the steps of the Tabernacle. It is also believed that these Psalms are sung when the exiles were returning from Babylon and pilgrims were going up to the temple on the mountain.

Hallel songs (praise and thanksgiving) were sung before and after Passover 113-118. Jesus may have sung Psalm 118 after Passover. (Matt 26:30)

Hallelujah songs 146-150 – song begins and ends with the word hallelujah Alphabet psalm: 9, 10, 25, 34, 37, 11, 112, 119, and 145 (patterned after Hebrew alphabet).

Thanksgiving Psalm 135-139

Songs of protection 140-143

Songs of praise 144, 145

Blessed people according to Psalms: 1:1,2, 2:12, 32:1, 33:12, 34:8, 41:1, 84:3-4, 94:12, 112:1, 119:2

There are 150 psalms.

QUESTIONS

1. How is the Hebrew Bible divided? What are the names of the sections? Which section is Psalms a part of?
2. Describe the origin of the word Psalm.
3. Who are the authors of the Psalms? How many psalms did each author write?
4. Describe how Jesus is seen in the Psalms.
5. How can we classify the messianic psalms? How many different types are there?
6. Write a brief essay about the classification of psalms, poetic nature, musical notes.
7. Psalms have been quoted in the New Testament more often than other books. Explain.

LESSON 20

PROVERBS

PURPOSE The fear of God and wisdom are essential for ideal Christian life.

Memory verses:
Proverbs Chapter 1:5-7 & 3:5,6

The wise man also may hear and increase in learning, and the man of understanding acquire skill, to understand a proverb and a figure, the words of the wise and their riddles. The fear of the Lord is the beginning of knowledge; fools despise wisdom and instruction.

Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and do not rely on your own insight. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths.

INTRODUCTION

This book emphasizes the fear of God and justice for the success of a practical Christian life.

This book also can be divided into five sections like Psalms , and the five books of Moses in the old testament.

- 1 Solomon's Proverbs (Proverbs chapter 1-9)
- 2 Solomon's words of wisdom (10-24)
- 3 Solomon's Proverbs, collected by the people of Hizkiah (25-29)

4 Words of Agur (30th chapter)

5 Lemuel's words (31st chapter)

Most of the words in this book belong to Solomon. Therefore this book is called Solomon's Proverbs. Just like Psalms is the book of meditation, proverbs is a book of practical knowledge. The fear of God is mentioned 14 times in this book

The book of proverbs is simple, genuine and wise statements. A majority of it contains instructions for children and young adults. The fear of God, knowledge, wisdom, freedom, holiness, self control, faith in God the right use of wealth, matters of priority in life, compassion for poor, restraining the tongue, love for your enemies, how to choose right friends, how to take care of children, hard works, honesty, laziness, carelessness, justice, help, attention, common sense and such matters relevant to life are discussed extensively in this book. Instructions are given in this book to keep us from going astray from life's goals. The presentation in this book is similar to a father instructing his children rather than "Thus saith the Lord" style in the 5 books of Moses. The book of Proverbs is called the best guide book for young men. Although Solomon was a good guide, he was not a good example. Therefore even Solomon's own children (Rehobiam) did not follow his ways.

By inspiration from God in this book, Solomon provided practical knowledge, in a heart warming manner through poems, examples, question and answers, small stories and advice.

Proverbs may be considered a historical book because it gives hints to many historical matters, This book was taught in schools in Israel (Jeremiah 18;18, Ezekiel 7:26). Three sects of people carried out Gods work—prophets, priest, & elders. Preachers had an important role in learning centers. The preacher (Qoheleth) was also the principal and teacher. The preachers address their audiences as "My son."

In Hebrew this book is called Mishle shelomoh, in Greek Paroimiai Solomontos, and in Latin Liber Proverbiorum(pro=for, verba=words). Proverbs use a single word in place of many words

for simplicity. In the writings of Rabbais proverbs are referred to as Sepher Hokhmah- the book of knowledge.

AUTHOR

The authors of this book are Solomon, men of king Hizkiah, Agur, and Lemuel However it is generally believed that Solomon is the author of Proverbs. In their search for knowledge, even other kings sought his wisdom .They considered Solomon a great ruler, wise man, and paragon of knowledge.

In 3 areas of this book Solomon's name has been mentioned first Proverbs 10:1 (10:1- 22 :16), and 25:1 (25-29) It is said that Solomon authored 3000 Proverbs and 1005 hymns (1 Kings 4:32). This book contains only 800 of these proverbs. God granted him prosperity and fame (1 Kings 11:4). Solomon may have combined both his and his contemporaries' proverbs (12:9). This collection of proverbs may contain sayings by men of Hizekiah (25 to 29) Micah and Isaiah were the prophets during the reign of Hezekiah. They might have helped Hezekiah in collecting the proverbs. There was no one better than Solomon in writing proverbs. There are no details in the Bible about Agur (30) Lemuel (31).They might have been wise men who worked closely with Solomon.

PERIOD OF WRITING (BC 100-680)

Solomon's proverbs may have been written during or before 931 BC and Hezekiah's collection was 230 years later during B.C. 715 to 680.

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

During the reign of Solomon and Hezekiah.

CHRIST IN THE BOOK PROVERBS

In Proverbs chapter 8: 12-31, we can see the full picture of knowledge. This is the source of spiritual & physical life (proverbs 8: 35, 36 and chapter 3:18), and justice (chapter 8:1- 6 , 32-35) These portion depict Christ who is the incarnation of knowledge (Colossians chapter 2: 3—1 Corinthians chapter 1:30 - & 22 to 24).

MAIN TOPIC

The main theme is knowledge.

OBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

Among all the other books in the Bible, Proverbs is the only book which states its purpose (1: 2-6). Proverbs was written for discernment & understanding. In Proverbs chapter 31 an ideal woman is depicted (a good woman, a good wife, good mother, good neighbor, good habits, good conversation, good life) and in chapter 7 a foolish woman is described. The book instructs on secrets of success in day to day life and helps the readers to discern them.

All matters concerning life are included in this book, such as knowledge, foolishness, justice, injustice, arrogance, humility, love, hatred, spiritual thoughts, anger, patience, hardwork, laziness, master-servant, life-death, family, time, culture, poverty, wealth, friends & neighbors.

The Book can be divided as follows:

Purpose of writing (chapter 1 V 1-7)

For the youth (chapter 1 v 8 to 9 and 18,)

Solomon's wisdom (chapter 10 V 1-24; 34)

Hezekiah (chapter 25 V 1-29)

Agar's: (chapter 30:1-33)

Lemuel (chapter 31: V 1-31)

The purpose of Writing:

1:1-7 The author clarified the purpose and subject here.

Proverbs for the youth (1:8-9:18)

In this section, there are 10 instructions given like a father advising his son in the ways of God. They all begin with "My Son". Cruelty and foolishness are condemned and safety and freedom are extolled. Foolishness, laziness, adultery, traps by evil woman

and spiritual treasures are discussed. Especially, 4 types of fools are presented:

- 1) Those who reject God's ways (Lemuel)
- (2) Those who are not dedicated
- (3) Wicked (4) Those who justify themselves

Collection by Hezekiah's sages (25:1-29:27)

These collections are by king Hezekiah's sages (25:1). These can be seen in chapters 25 to 29. These are expansions of Solomon's proverbs.

Agur's sayings (30:1-33)

The last two chapters are additions by two unknown authors. Agur's proverbs are numerical proverbs.

Words of King Lemuel.

The last chapter of proverbs is by this author. Words are arranged according to the Hebrew alphabet. The presentation is the glorious picture of an ideal wife (31: 10-31).

Book of Proverbs contains 31 chapters.

QUESTIONS

1. What is the similarity between the 5 books of Moses and Proverbs?
2. Why is Proverbs called the best guide for young men?
3. What are the root words/names for this Book?
4. Who are the authors of Proverbs? Why is Proverbs called the book of Solomon?
5. Knowledge/Wisdom reflect Christ. Show examples of that from this book.
6. Prepare a book review of Proverbs.

LESSON 21

ECCLESIASTES

PURPOSE: Solomon's revelation of the world's emptiness and meaninglessness.

Memory verses:

Ecclesiastes 2:24 & 12:13, 14

There is nothing better for a man than that he should eat and drink, and find enjoyment in his toil. This also, I saw, is from the hand of God.

The end of the matter; all has been heard. Fear God, and keep his commandments; for this is the whole duty of man. For God will bring every deed into judgment, with every secret thing, whether good or evil.

INTRODUCTION

The author Solomon is known for his wisdom, wealth and literary excellence. He is known as 'the great king'. The theme of this book is to depict the "Meaninglessness of Life". This book glorifies wisdom. It also speaks of the hard work and sadness in the life of David. David handed over the kingdom to his son Solomon after completing everything required for the completion of the temple work and rule of the kingdom. Solomon received everything he needed from his father to rule and live a peaceful, happy and fulfilled life but he chose to live his life luxuriously and showcase his wealth and human power. This meaninglessness lifestyle led to a life filled with no joy and emptiness. In the book we see meaninglessness repeated 37 times. Solomon did not fully understand the concept of eternal life that Jesus promised (2 Tim.1:10). He lived 1000 years before Christ. Solomon's lifestyle which focused on worldly pleasures finally leads him to lamenting

“meaningless! meaningless! Utterly meaningless, everything is meaningless”.

HOW THIS BOOK IS PART OF THE BIBLE

Solomon's thoughts were not always godly (1 Kings. 12 , He had 700 wives, 300 concubines , involved many other sinful needs, idol worship). A luxurious life can lead even a good person to destruction, but one gets their lessons in this book from God. In this book, God teaches Solomon, a man who had lived his life through different phases, the true purpose of life. God teaches Solomon to find the true purpose of life as worded by him in final thoughts in the book. Man's thirst can only be fulfilled through Christ. In Christ there is no 'meaningless living' but a life filled with joy, peace and happiness. Solomon's lifestyle of “eat, drink, be merry for you will die tomorrow” is known as Epicurism among the Greek.

The book of Ecclesiastes is a collection of thoughts about everything under the sun. It gives guidelines and directions to people on earth as to how to lead a purposeful life. The book starts with information about everything under the sun and comes to an end with reverence to God.

The book of Ecclesiastes is known as Koheleth in Hebrew, which means 'one who speaks to a group of people'. The term Ecclesiastes in Greek is “ecclesia”, in Latin “concinator” and in English ‘preacher’ as was used to lead in Jewish festivals.

AUTHOR

Chapter 1: 1 starts with saying “Solomon King of Jerusalem, son of David”. The book speaks about Solomon's wisdom, happiness, wealth and his servants. The author of this book is Solomon—this can be deduced from the following. The term Kohaleth used in the book refers to Solomon himself. There are seven verses in this book which are similar to verses in Proverbs written by Solomon. Hence it's logical to believe that Solomon wrote three books: “Song of Songs” during his Youth, Proverbs during his middle age and Ecclesiastes during his old age.

PERIOD OF WRITING:

Based on the language used in the literature, Solomon is to have written this book in B.C. 905, during the time of his rule.

CHRIST IF THE BOOK OF ECCLESIASTES

There is emptiness in all human hearts which can be only filled by Christ himself. In Christ you have full joy, fulfillment and wisdom (12:11, John. 10:9,10). Any happiness apart from Christ is futile.

MAIN TOPIC: Life without Christ is empty and meaningless.

OVBSERVATION ABOUT THE BOOK

The term “under the sun” is used 23 times and ‘meaninglessness’ is used 37 times in this book. Life is a gift from God on a daily basis which has to be enjoyed but we must also be faithful and be thankful to God Almighty. This is what Solomon teaches us in the book. The answer to a purposeful life is a life with submission to God and leading a godly life.

This is the answer to many human problems. The book reveals a person who was engaged in worldly pleasures and became dissatisfied. Physical, carnal, mental and political pleasures of life will lead one to discontentment and emptiness.

DIVISION OF TOPIC

1. Everything is meaningless; chapter 1:1-11
2. Theme of meaninglessness is explained 1:12 to 6:12
3. Wisdom as to how to live a meaningful life 7:1 to 12:14.

A purposeful life is obtained through Christ. To have God and man’s selfish thoughts stand together in one body is impossible; for this reason man falls into emptiness. There is no solution for this emptiness under the sun but the only solution is to look up to God. There are 12 chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. What is the reasoning for the luxurious life being meaningless in Solomon's life?
 2. What is the conclusion in the book of Ecclesiastes?
 3. Define the meaning of the term "Ecclesiastes".
 4. What evidence is there to believe that the author of the book of Ecclesiastes is Solomon?
 5. What is the role of Christ in the book of Ecclesiastes?
 6. How can you say that this book of Ecclesiastes provides a guide the for solution of problems?
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LESSON 22

SONG OF SONGS

Destruction of Babylon the Great and wedding of the Lamb

PURPOSE Jehovah is the bride-room for Israel and Jesus
Christ is the bridegroom or the Church.

Memory verses:
Song of Songs 7:11; 8:7

*Come, my beloved, let us go forth into the field,
and lodge in the villages;*

*Many waters cannot quench love, neither can floods
drown it if a man offered for a love all the wealth of
his house, it would be utterly scorned*

INTRODUCTION

The main theme is the greatness of married love. A beautiful love song sprung in the spring season. The Song of Songs is full of parables and allegory and exemplifies Solomon's love for nature. Green pastures, flower gardens, springs, vineyards, fruitful trees and herds are all in there (1 King 4:33).

The reason behind calling this the Song of Songs is that out of Solomon's 1005 songs, this was the best. This is also known as Canticles. In this book we see the tender emotions of his loving wife after their marriage. Hebrew critiques consider this a perfect book. There are shortcomings in explaining certain translations from Hebrew in certain areas such as time, place etc for proper presentation, explanations and meanings.

In this book the bride is a Shulamite (6:13) and the bridegroom is king Solomon. The choir group in the palace are the virgins of Jerusalem. They are the maidens of the queen. Their conversations are the theme in certain areas. It is difficult to figure out who is the one talking. At that time, Solomon had 60 wives and 80 concubines and maidens. Later it increased to 700 wives and 300 maidens totaling 1000 women. (Prov.6:8, 1 King 11:3) It is not clear who the bride is in this book. It is commonly believed that it was Abishag, the Shulamite (1 King 1:1-4, 2:17-22). The maiden who was very beautiful, nursed the king and cared for him in his final days of life became his wife. This may have been done to make her happy after his marriage. Marriage is according to God's will. (Genesis 2:24). That is why Song of Songs is considered as a part of Bible. Only in marriage, it is possible to think deep into the secrets of a bride. It is essential to get married to make one happy and satisfied. That is why it is included in the books of the Bible.

For Jews, there is another thought in their mind. The Lord is the bridegroom of the Israelites. Israel is the bride. They read this in the festival of Passover. This reminds them of the journey (Isa.54:5-6, Jere. 2-2, Hose. 2:16, 18-20, Jer. 3:1, Ezek. 16:20,

21,32 & 38.) A Christian interprets Christ as the bridegroom and the church as the bride.(Mat. 9.15,25.1,John 3.29, 2cor 11.2, Eph5.23-32,Rev 19.7, 21.2, 22.17) Marriage is the relationship equivalent of the relationship between Christ and the Church.

This is a drama, a love lyric. This is not a continuous story or a “serial”. There is no technicality of a drama, only broken scenes of songs. Jews under the age of 30 were supposed to read this book. A great deal of importance is given in this book for love between the bride and bridegroom in their spiritual life. The hidden meaning in this book has a lot of spiritual value. This book contains 13 songs in eight chapters.

1st song 1.2-6

2nd 1.7-8

3rd 1.9-17

4th 2.1-7

5th 2.8-17

6th 3.1-5

7th 3.6-11

8th 4.1-7

9th 4.8-5.1

10th 5.2-6.3

11th 6.4-7.10

12th 7.11-8.4

13th 8.5-14

This book shows 15 different places, from Jordan (on the north) to Egypt (on the south).

Kedar(1.5), Egypt (1.9), Elgedi(1.14), Sharon(2.1), Jerusalem (2.7), Lebanon 3.9, Mountains of Gilayad 4.1, Amana 4.8 Shenir 4.8, Hermon 4.8,Thirsa 6.4,Hesbon 7.4, Demmasek7.4 Carmel 7.5 Bal Hamon 8.11. There are 49 names we see here only. There are 21 perfume-giving trees and 15 perfume-giving animals in this. This is included in the Jewish Megilloth scrolls. The Shalomite girl calls him ‘My Lover’ and Solomon calls her ‘My Love’. Shunem is

located southwest of the sea of Galilee and is inhabited by the Isahaghar tribe. She is called the Shulemite girl since she is a native of that place.

Solomon had a vineyard in Baal Hamon (Shulem) (6.13, 8.11). The Shulemite girl with her brothers took care of the vineyard (16,8.11,12). She turned dark because of the heat from the sun. Inspite of that she was so beautiful (1.6-9). One day Solomon visited that vineyard. He fell in love with this girl to such an extent that he separated her from her lover who was with her. He bought her to the palace and married her.

This is called Shir Hashirim, a Hebrew name, meaning Song of Songs. Among all songs, this is the best of the songs from Solomon and that is why it is called Song of Songs. In Greek it is called Asma Asmaton and in Latin Canticum Canticorum, meaning Song of Songs.

INTERPRETATIONS

1. Literal Interpretations

The literal meaning of this is simply aimed at human love, an example of real love between a man and a woman. The shepherd boy was rejected by Solomon and Solomon becomes the main actor. This is a love song based on shepherd hypothesis.

2. Allegorical Interpretations.

The relationship between Solomon and the Shulamite girl represents the relationship between the Lord and Israelites in the Old Testament and Christ and the Church in the New Testament.

3. Typical Interpretation.

In this type of interpretation comparison is made only in certain aspects. Solomon and the girl cannot be compared in all aspects to Christ and the Church.

4. Certain people compare this to fictional and certain others to Historical dramas.

AUTHOR

We see this as Solomon's Song of Songs. Therefore we believe that the author is Solomon. Some people think that this is about Solomon. Based on 1:4, 3:7-11, 8:11, the description of wealth, a luxurious life-style, knowledge, in depth knowledge of birds, animals, bushes and trees—no other person at the time fits this description except Solomon.

PERIOD OF WRITING 10Th Century B.C.

HISTORY OF THE PERIOD

Beginning of Solomon's reign – About one year.

CHRIST IN SONG OF SONGS

Christ- the bride-groom, Church- the bride (2Cor.11:2, Eph. 5:23-25, Rev. 19:7-9, 21:9)

MAIN TOPIC

The real relationship between bride and bridegroom in married life. (Shadow of love between Christ and the Church)

OBSERVATIONS ABOUT THE BOOK

1 The beginning of love(1.1-5.1)

Solomon fell in love with the girl and brought her to the palace in Jerusalem. She loved to observe nature instead of staying in palace (1.2-3). The following scenes are described in the book—the banquet table for the wedding (1.9-2.7), the arrival of spring, the king's visit to the bride's village home(2.8-17), the dream about the separation of the bridegroom(3.1-5), the royal journey from the bride's home after the wedding (3.6-11). Solomon (bridegroom) gives a detailed explanation of the girl from head to toe, compares her to a vineyard fenced completely, but having one door opened for the bridegroom only,(4.1-15), this union is from God (4.16-5.1).

2 The extension of love 5.2-8.14

A dream about separation from the bridegroom 5:1, she searches for him on the streets of Jerusalem, she becomes love sick(5:3-6.3), she finds him, he describes her beauty again (6:4-7,10), the girl remembers her native country, she encourages him to visit there (7:11, 8:4), the journey of the bridegroom(8:5-7), their love becomes deep, he comes home (8.8- 14), remembers the childhood days(8:8,9) compares it with the present situation. The poem comes to an end with praise of the bridegroom (8:13,14). There are eight chapters in this book.

QUESTIONS

1. How does the Song of Songs explain Solomon's love of nature?
2. Why is this book called the Song of Songs?
3. Who are the main characters in this bppl?
4. Why it is believed that this bride is Abishag?
5. Why did this become a Kannonite book?
6. Give a small historical account of the Shulamite girl?
7. How many divisions are there based on the interpretations and what are they?
8. How does the Song of Song reveal the relationship between Christ and the Church?
9. Make an observation of Song of Songs.